Ramsey-Free Bounds for Two-Stage Shared-Decoder Composition

Hans Brende Gemini 4 Carbon (Google DeepMind)

November 2026

Abstract

Section 6 of [8] studied two-stage compositions $K_2 \circ K_1$ of linear class-uniform shared decoders on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ with M_1 and M_2 column classes, using van der Waerden and Hales–Jewett arithmetic progressions to bound d when $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ and to show that $\mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)/(bd) \to \infty$ as $d \to \infty$ at fixed M_1, M_2 when $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ ($(d : F) \neq 0$). No multitape Turing machine is known to induce such a two-stage linear class-uniform factorization; working within the same algebraic model, this paper replaces arithmetic progressions by Ramsey-free additive structures and proves two main composition bounds in Lean 4.

First (Theorem 3.3), over any field F and for $b, M_1, M_2 \geq 1$, replacing progressions by affine Hilbert cubes extracted via iterated Cauchy–Schwarz proves that $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ forces

$$d \;\leq\; \max\bigl(8M_1M_2^2,\; (2M_1)^{2^{M_2}}\bigr).$$

This rules out exact two-stage linear factorizations for growing class schedules up to $M_1 = o\bigl(d^{1/2^{M_2}}\bigr)$ at fixed M_2 (including 3-AP-free Behrend partitions with $M_1 = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$) and $M_2 \leq (1-\varepsilon)\log_2\log_2 d$ at fixed M_1 and $\varepsilon \in (0,1)$ (giving $d \leq \max(8M_1, 4M_1^2)$ at $M_2 = 1$), though at small constant class counts such as $M_1 = M_2 = 2$ it gives $d \leq 256$ where Corollary 6.4 of [8] gives $d \leq 16$. Second (Theorem 4.6), over any field F with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$, combining shifted $(2M_2)$-fold monochromatic sumsets, arbitrary-subset Vandermonde pullbacks, sparse annihilating polynomials, and iterated Kővári–Sós–Turán extraction proves that for all $b, M_1, M_2 \geq 1$ and all $d \geq D_0(M_1, M_2)$,

$$\mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \;\geq\; c(M_1, M_2)\, b\, d\, (\log d)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}},$$

giving $\Omega(b\,d\log d)$ when $M_2 = 1$ (Corollary 4.8), with explicit constants where $D_0(1,1) = 16^{36} + 2 \approx 2.23 \times 10^{43}$. Finite-dimensional controls at $d = 13$, $d = 4$, and $d = 12$ test the hypotheses of both bounds.

Three further sections prove one-stage linear shared-decoder and two-sided swap-code bounds on open problems of [3], alongside two shorter companion sections. On [3, Problem 9.1(a)], exploiting decoder linearity on maximal monochromatic cyclic runs proves an explicit single-shift intersection bound $B_{\mathrm{run}}(b,p,s)$ when $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid (d/\gcd(d,s))$ (Theorem 5.2, whose value $\frac{1}{4}d^2 + \frac{3}{2}d$ on the alternating two-coloring for even $d = 2m \geq 2$ at $b = 1, s = 1$ is realized over every field, Theorem 5.3). Averaging over shifts bounds the maximum b-lane code dimension $D_b(p)$ by $D_b(p) \leq \frac{19}{32}\,bd^2 + \frac{3}{2}\,bd^{3/2}$ for two classes whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ (Theorem 5.4, strictly below both the $\frac{41}{64}$ bound of [8, Theorem 3.4] and the $\frac{5}{8}$ nonlinear-decoder certificate floor of [8, Theorem C.6]), and by $D_b(p) \leq \bigl(1 - \frac{5}{4M} + \frac{1}{M^2} - \frac{1}{4M^3}\bigr)bd^2 + bMd$ for $M \geq 3$ at primes $d \neq \mathrm{char}(F)$ (Theorem 5.5, whose leading coefficient beats the flag bound $1 - \frac{1}{2M}$ for every $M \geq 2$, while Theorem 3.5 of [8] has a smaller leading coefficient at $M = 50$ and $M \geq 55$, carries no $O(bMd)$ term, and applies to composite d). On [3, Problem 9.1(b)], coupled $\mathbb{Z}_6$ Fourier-mode elimination proves $\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \leq 14$ and hence $D_1\bigl(\{0,1,3\},\{2,4,5\}\bigr) = 25$ over every field with $\mathrm{char}(F) \notin \{2,3\}$ (Theorem 6.2, leaving characteristics 2 and 3 open). For swap codes, we construct three-term families $\sum_{t=0}^{2} A_t X B_t^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ over every field exceeding $d(d+1)/2$ at $d \in \{6,7,9,12\}$ and uniformly at $d = 4$ ([3, Remark 5.6]), and prove a characteristic-free

two-sided coarse–fine bound on [3, Problem 9.3] (Theorem 7.4 and Corollary 7.5) giving, on contiguous fine singletons of densities $\alpha = s_A/d, \beta = s_B/d \in (0,1)$ plus one coarse complement, leading coefficient $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\min\big(\beta(1+\alpha), \alpha(1+\beta)\big) < \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}\min(\alpha,\beta)$ (and $\frac{11}{16}d^2 + d < \frac{3}{4}d^2$ at $\alpha = \beta = 1/2$ for all even $d \geq 18$). Finally, we prove an Operator Schmidt Rank pass lower bound ($t \geq \log_2 d$) for a restricted shuffle/unshuffle pipeline paired with verified $O(L)$-time Turing machines ($L = d^2 \max(1, \lceil \log_2 d \rceil)$) in `lean-machine` for shuffle, unshuffle, and within-row shear showing why $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes$ does not answer [3, Problem 9.5], together with cut-causal cone evaluation on frozen `Transpose.TM` fibres, a Lean formalization of the $1/(\Delta+1)$ random-order bound at entry read arity Δ ([4, Proposition 4.14(a)–(b)]), and why nonlinear set fibres and per-entry cut labels stop subspace and column-class arguments short of [3, Problem 9.4(b)]. Statement (T) remains open.

Contributions. Hans Brende chose the problem, fixed the verification standard, and directed the research. Gemini 4 Carbon (Google DeepMind) developed the mathematics, wrote the Lean 4 formalizations, and wrote the manuscript under his direction. Claude Fable 5.2 (Anthropic) conducted an external review of an earlier draft that identified vacuous statements in a preliminary sweep-extraction section, corrected cross-paper attributions, and recommended refocusing the paper around two-stage shared-decoder composition and moving the verified shuffle and shear machines to `lean-machine`.

Contents

1 Introduction **4**
- 1.1 Context and scope . . . 4
- 1.2 Summary of results . . . 5
- 1.3 Formalization conventions . . . 7

2 Model and preliminaries **7**
- 2.1 Matrix states, class-uniform operators, and bounded-arity set codes . . . 7
- 2.2 Multitape Turing machines, canonical words, and grid bridges . . . 9

3 Affine Hilbert cubes and Ramsey-free two-stage cutoffs **10**
- 3.1 Common-message growth on ordered operator cubes . . . 10
- 3.2 Iterated Cauchy–Schwarz cube extraction and Theorem 2A . . . 11
- 3.3 Finite controls at $d = 13$ and $d = 4$ . . . 12

4 Shifted sumsets and logarithmic two-stage rank deficits **13**
- 4.1 Minimum-shifted monochromatic sumsets . . . 13
- 4.2 Arbitrary-subset Vandermonde pullback and sparse annihilating polynomials . . . 14
- 4.3 Sumset rank bound, Kővári–Sós–Turán extraction, and Theorem 2B . . . 15
- 4.4 Abstract band relaxation control at $d = 12$ . . . 17

5 Run-extension bounds for one-stage linear shared decoders **18**
- 5.1 Why nonlinear translate certificates stall at 5/8, and run-extension for linear decoders 18
- 5.2 Universal 19/32 two-class ceiling and prime-d multi-class bounds . . . 20

6 Exact dimension 25 for the aperiodic partition of $\mathbb{Z}_6$ **22**

7 Three-term swap codes and one- and two-sided interval-mask bounds **24**
7.1 Three-term swap codes exceeding $d(d+1)/2$ at $d \in \{6, 7, 9, 12\}$ and over all fields at $d = 4$ . . . 24
7.2 One-sided and two-sided bounds for multi-scale interval masks (Problem 9.3) . . . 26

8 Restricted shuffle-and-local operator pipelines and anti-diagonal untwisting **30**
8.1 Operator Schmidt Rank on restricted shuffle pipelines and linear-time machines . . . 30
8.2 Anti-diagonal untwisting of shift-collision equations . . . 33

9 Cut-cone evaluation, random-order capacity, and per-entry cut labels **34**
9.1 Cut-causal cone evaluation on frozen `Transpose.TM` fibres . . . 34
9.2 Lean formalization of the $1/(\Delta + 1)$ random-order bound for shared set codes . . . 35
9.3 Why column classes cannot absorb per-entry cut labels . . . 37
9.4 Open problems . . . 38

A Formalization architecture **39**

B Index of Lean declarations **40**

C Building and verifying **42**

1 Introduction

1.1 Context and scope

Let $d \geq 2$, let $b = \lceil \log_2 d \rceil$ be the canonical entry bit-width, and let $L = d^2 b = \Theta(d^2 \log d)$ be the bit-length of a $d \times d$ matrix of b-bit entries laid out row by row on the read-only input tape of a deterministic multitape Turing machine with k read-write work tapes and a one-way write-only output tape ([5, Sections 2.1–2.2 and Definition 2.1]). Statement (T) ([5, Definition 2.1], `Transpose.LinearTimeTransposable`) asserts that some such machine transposes all $d \times d$ matrices of b-bit entries within $O(L)$ steps; Conjecture 9.1 of [5] formulates a stronger asymmetric bipartite storage-coding conjecture (the Tape Coding Conjecture) whose refutation of Statement (T) is Lean-verified there ([5, Theorem 9.2]), and by Harvey and van der Hoeven [11, Corollary 6.9], if Statement (T) is false then no linear-time multitape integer multiplier exists either.

The synthesis paper *Order, Symmetry and the Swap* [3] organized the algebraic obstacles studied across the series into two one-stage mechanisms on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$: an order bound for two-term operators $A_1 X B_1^{\mathsf{T}} + A_2 X B_2^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ giving dimension at most $d(d+1)/2$ ([3, Theorem 5.1 and Corollary 5.5]; coordinate form of Theorem 5.1 Lean-verified, Corollary 5.5 proved in text), and a translate-pigeonhole bound (Theorem TP, [3, Definition 6.3 and Theorem 6.4], Lean-verified) for class-uniform rules in which column c of the output is computed by applying one of M shared linear decoders to the column-rotated matrix $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)_{i,j} = X_{i,j+c}$. As emphasized in [3, Sections 4.2 and 4.6], abstract storage-code models without shared rules admit high-rate network coding, whereas the class-uniform model captures translation covariance along a single regular sweep.

In the sequel *Capacity and Composition of Shared Transposition Decoders* [8, Section 6] (where all results cited in this paper are Lean-verified), Brende and GPT-6 Astra initiated the study of *two-stage compositions* $K_2 \circ K_1$ of linear class-uniform operators on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$, where K_1 has M_1 column classes and K_2 has M_2 column classes:

- For exact factorizations $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ over any field F, Theorem 6.3 of [8] reduced two-stage composition to a common-message subspace inside a cyclic channel module and extracted a monochromatic arithmetic progression in the stage-1 partition, proving $d \leq M_2\big(\mathsf{W}(M_1, M_2 + 1) - 1\big)$, where W denotes a van der Waerden threshold; at $M_1, M_2 \leq 2$, Corollary 6.4 of [8] used $\mathsf{W}(2,3) \leq 9$ to obtain the small-parameter bound $d \leq 16$.

- For approximate factorizations over any field F with $(d : F) \neq 0$, Theorem 6.6 of [8] proved that $r := \mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)$ satisfies

$$r \;\geq\; \frac{bk(d - N_0 + 1)}{2}, \qquad \ell = (2M_2 + 1)k - 1, \quad N_0 = \mathsf{W}(M_1, \ell),$$

  showing that $r/(bd) \to \infty$ as $d \to \infty$ for every fixed pair (M_1, M_2), using qualitative finiteness of van der Waerden numbers via the Hales–Jewett theorem [10] without substituting a numerical upper bound for $\mathsf{W}(M_1, \ell)$.

This paper is primarily a sequel to [8] and [3] in that same linear algebraic model. We state the model boundary up front: *no multitape Turing machine is known to decompose into one- or two-stage linear class-uniform stages*, and none of the results of this paper decides Statement (T) or bridges general adaptive or oblivious machines to linear shared decoders. Within the linear class-uniform and swap-code models, however, exploiting *linearity of the shared decoders* removes two separate ceilings from prior work: in two-stage composition ([8, Section 6]), replacing arithmetic progressions (which Behrend's construction [2] limits to length < 3 at $M_1 = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$ and whose

worst-case monochromatic length is $O(\log d)$ even at $M_1 = 2$) by *affine Hilbert cubes* (over every field) and *shifted monochromatic sumsets* (when $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$, i.e. $(d : F) \neq 0$) removes Ramsey numbers; and in one-stage capacity ([3, Problem 9.1(a)–(b)]; [8, Section 3 and Appendix C]), run-extension equations at the right endpoints of monochromatic cyclic runs push strictly past the $\frac{5}{8}$ certificate floor imposed by $C \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(C) \leq H_{\{0,s\}}$ for nonlinear decoders and determine $D_1(\{0,1,3\},\{2,4,5\}) = 25$ on $\mathbb{Z}_6$ outside characteristics 2 and 3.

1.2 Summary of results

1. **Ramsey-free cutoff for exact two-stage linear composition (Section 3).** Over an *arbitrary* field F, Lemma 3.1 proves that if a subspace $W \leq A$ admits an injective linear readout invariant under the 2^k ordered products $R_{k-1}^{\varepsilon_{k-1}} \cdots R_0^{\varepsilon_0}$ of k endomorphisms $R_0, \ldots, R_{k-1} \in \mathrm{End}_F(A)$, then

$$(k+1)\dim_F W \;\leq\; \dim_F A \;+\; \sum_{t=0}^{k-1} \dim_F \ker(R_t - \mathrm{id}_A).$$

   Extracting a monochromatic affine M_2-cube with small steps $1 \leq s_t \leq \lfloor d/(2M_2^2) \rfloor$ by iterated Cauchy–Schwarz (Lemma 3.2) yields Theorem 3.3: whenever $b, M_1, M_2 \geq 1$ and two F-linear class-uniform stages K_1, K_2 on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ with M_1 and M_2 classes satisfy $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$, one has

$$d \;\leq\; \max\Big(8M_1M_2^2,\; (2M_1)^{2^{M_2}}\Big).$$

   For fixed M_2, this rules out exact factorizations for growing $M_1(d) = o(d^{1/2^{M_2}})$, including 3-AP-free Behrend partitions with $M_1(d) = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$. At small constant class counts, however, Theorem 3.3 is weaker than van der Waerden extraction: at $M_1 = M_2 = 2$, Theorem 3.3 gives $d \leq 256$, whereas Corollary 6.4 of [8] gives $d \leq 16$. Two finite controls accompany Theorem 3.3: at $d = 13, q = 2$ on the 3-AP-free 2-cube $J_{13} = \{0,1,4,5\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{13}$, Example 3.5 shows $9 \leq \max \dim_F W \leq 10$ over fields with $(13 : F) \neq 0$ (refuting a naive 2^k-multiplier bound $\dim_F W \leq 8$); and at $d = 4 = M_1M_2$ on the identical two-interval partition $p_1 = p_2 = [0,0,1,1]$, Example 3.6 constructs exact linear coded factorizations $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ for all lane widths $b \geq 0$ over every field with $(5 : F) \neq 0$ (leaving characteristic 5 open for $b \geq 1$), while showing that entry-copy and bit-lane-copy factorizations fail for $b \geq 1$.

2. **Log-power error-rank lower bound for approximate two-stage composition (Section 4).** Over any field F with $(d : F) \neq 0$, we pass to a splitting field carrying an injective additive character $\chi : \mathbb{Z}_d \to E^\times$ and replace progressions of length $(2M_2+1)k - 1$ by $(2M_2)$-fold monochromatic sumsets $\widetilde{J}_0 + \widetilde{B}_0 + \cdots + \widetilde{B}_{2M_2-2}$ with $|\widetilde{J}_0| = k$, $0 \in \widetilde{B}_t$, and $|\widetilde{B}_t| = k+1$. Because $\big(\chi(\nu c)\big)_{c\in\widetilde{J}_0, 0\leq\nu<k}$ is a Vandermonde matrix in the distinct scalars $\chi(c)$ ($c \in \widetilde{J}_0$), stacked evaluation over any k-element set $\widetilde{J}_0$ is injective on the frequency-$< k$ band (Lemma 4.2), while each $(k+1)$-element summand $\widetilde{B}_t$ supports a nonzero polynomial P_t of degree at most $\mathrm{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}_t)$ annihilating the band (Lemma 4.3). Combining the resulting rank inequality $2\,\mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \geq bk\big(d - \sum_t \mathrm{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}_t)\big)$ (Theorem 4.4) with iterated Kővári–Sós–Turán sumset extraction (Lemma 4.5) yields Theorem 4.6: for all $b, M_1, M_2 \geq 1$ and all $d \geq D_0(M_1, M_2)$ with $(d : F) \neq 0$,

$$\mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \;\geq\; c(M_1, M_2)\, b\, d\, (\log d)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}},$$

and in particular $\Omega(b\,d\log d)$ when $M_2 = 1$ (Corollary 4.8). The bound is asymptotic: the formalized threshold $D_0(M_1, M_2)$ printed in Theorem 4.6 satisfies $D_0(1,1) = 16^{36} + 2 \approx 2.23 \times 10^{43}$. Example 4.9 constructs an explicit 24-dimensional 4-channel band witness ($q = 4$, $bM_2 = 2$) over $\mathbb{C}$ at $d = 12$ showing that stage-1 shift invariance cannot be relaxed to an abstract linear readout on a single $k = 2$ band space.

3. **Run-extension bounds for one-stage linear shared decoders (Section 5).** In [8, Theorem 3.4 and Theorem C.6], iterating $C \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(C) \le H_{\{0,s\}}$ gave $\frac{41}{64}\,bd^2 + \frac{5}{3}\,bd^{3/2}$ for two classes and hit a $(\frac{5}{8} - o(1))bd^2$ certificate floor because $C \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(C) \le H_{\{0,s\}}$ holds for nonlinear deterministic decoders. For F-linear decoders ([3, Definition 6.3]), evaluating $\mathrm{rot}_s(X) \in \mathcal{X}$ at the right endpoint of each maximal monochromatic run along each cycle of $c \mapsto c+s$ supplies an extra linear equation per run. Filtering by rot_s-eigenmodes over $\overline{F}$ proves the single-shift bound $B_{\mathrm{run}}(b,p,s)$ (Theorem 5.2) whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid (d/\gcd(d,s))$, whose value $\frac{1}{4}d^2 + \frac{3}{2}d$ (versus $\dim_F H_{\{0,1\}} = d^2$) on the alternating two-coloring for even $d = 2m \ge 2$ at $b = 1, s = 1$ is realized over *every* field (Theorem 5.3, attaining Theorem 5.2 whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid 2m$). Averaging over shifts proves $D_b(p) \le \frac{19}{32}\,bd^2 + \frac{3}{2}\,bd^{3/2}$ for two classes whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ (Theorem 5.4, strictly below $\frac{5}{8} < \frac{41}{64}$, while positive characteristics dividing d and the gap from $\frac{19}{32}$ to $\frac{1}{2}$ remain open) and $D_b(p) \le (1 - \frac{5}{4M} + \frac{1}{M^2} - \frac{1}{4M^3})bd^2 + bMd$ for $M \ge 3$ at primes $d \ne \mathrm{char}(F)$ (Theorem 5.5). Its leading coefficient c_M beats the flag bound $1 - \frac{1}{2M}$ of [3, Theorem 5.1, Corollary 5.9(b), Remark 5.10, and Problem 9.1(a)] (coordinate form of Theorem 5.1 Lean-verified; Corollary 5.9(b) and Remark 5.10 proved in text) for every $M \ge 2$, and is smaller than the leading coefficient $1 - 1/(4\lceil\sqrt{2M}\,\rceil)$ of Theorem 3.5 of [8] for $2 \le M \le 49$ and $51 \le M \le 54$—improving on Theorem 3.5 for sufficiently large primes $d \ne \mathrm{char}(F)$ at $M \ge 3$, and for $d \ge 29$ with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ via Theorem 5.4 at $M = 2$ (whereas Theorem 5.4 improves on [8, Theorem 3.4] for all $d \ge 1$ with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$). Conversely, Theorem 3.5 of [8] has a smaller $\Theta(M^{-1/2})$ leading coefficient at $M = 50$ and $M \ge 55$, carries no $+bMd$ error term, and applies to composite $d \ge 2M$ and arbitrary characteristic.

4. **Exact dimension 25 for $\{0,1,3\} \mid \{2,4,5\}$ on $\mathbb{Z}_6$ outside characteristics 2 and 3 (Section 6).** On [3, Problem 9.1(b)], combining six-mode column-Fourier decomposition on $H_{\{0,1\}}$, an antipodal quotient bound $3\dim Q + S_K \le 24$, and kernel-disjointness / 4×4 row elimination (cleared determinant $2^4 \cdot 3^3 \ne 0$) at $S_K \in \{11, 12\}$ proves $\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \le 14$ (Lemma 6.1) and hence $D_1(\{0,1,3\},\{2,4,5\}) = 25$ over every field with $\mathrm{char}(F) \notin \{2,3\}$ (Theorem 6.2, paired with the lower bound of [7, Theorem 3.2]); characteristics 2 ($25 \le D_1 \le 28$) and 3 ($24 \le D_1 \le 28$, [7, Problem 6.1]) remain open.

5. **Three-term swap codes and one- and two-sided interval-mask bounds (Section 7).** In [3, Remark 5.6], examples of three-term swap codes $\{X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F) : \sum_{t=0}^{2} A_t X B_t^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}\}$ exceeding $d(d+1)/2$ were given at $d = 3$ ($8 > 6$, over every field) and $d = 4$ ($11 > 10$, checked numerically over $\mathbb{F}_2, \mathbb{F}_3, \mathbb{F}_5, \mathbb{F}_7$), with no example known for $d \ge 5$. In Theorems 7.1 and 7.2, we construct a 3×3 block family on $d = 3m$ achieving exact dimension $4m(m+1)$ over every field—exceeding $d(d+1)/2$ at $d \in \{3, 6, 9, 12\}$—and pad it to obtain $29 > 28$ at $d = 7$ and $11 > 10$ at $d = 4$ over every field; $d = 5$ and every $d \ge 8$ outside $\{9, 12\}$ remain open. On [3, Problem 9.3], after recording the one-sided endpoint-refinement baseline $(d^2 + d\min(\beta_A, \beta_B))/2$ (Proposition 7.3), we prove a characteristic-free two-sided coarse–fine bound (Theorem 7.4 and Corollary 7.5) whose leading coefficient $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\min(\beta(1+\alpha), \alpha(1+\beta))$ is strictly below one-sided Theorem TP's $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}\min(\alpha, \beta)$ for all $\alpha, \beta \in (0,1)$ (giving $\frac{11}{16}d^2 + d < \frac{3}{4}d^2$ at $\alpha = \beta = 1/2$ for all even $d \ge 18$), while Proposition 7.7 contrasts interval boundaries (≤ 2)

with periodic Walsh digit masks (2^{j+1} boundaries, profile 2 per scale, and operator span dimension $\leq (m+1)2^m$).

6. **Restricted shuffle-and-local operator pipelines and anti-diagonal untwisting (Section 8).** Across the row/column tensor cut $F^d_{\mathrm{row}} \otimes_F (F^d_{\mathrm{col}} \otimes_F F^b)$, Operator Schmidt Rank satisfies $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(\tau) = d^2$ and $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(S) = \mathrm{rk}_\otimes(S^{-1}) = 4$ for Stone's perfect shuffle and unshuffle [13] on $d = 2^m \geq 2$ (Theorem 8.2), forcing $t \geq m = \log_2 d$ shuffle/unshuffle passes in any pipeline composed solely of S, S^{-1}, row-uniform operators $I_d \otimes B$, and column-uniform operators $A \otimes I_{db}$ (Theorem 8.3). As we emphasize at the start of Section 8, this applies only to that restricted operator pipeline and *does not* answer [3, Problem 9.5]: within-row cyclic shear $X_{r,c} \mapsto X_{r,(c+r) \bmod d}$ has $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes = d$ (Proposition 8.5) yet runs in $O(L)$ time on a 2-work-tape Turing machine (Proposition 8.4, proved in the shared library `lean-machine` alongside 3-tape shuffle and 2-tape unshuffle). Section 8.2 also records the anti-diagonal coordinate isomorphism intertwining rot_t with $\mathrm{id} \otimes \sigma^t$ (where $(\sigma^t v)_a = v_{a+t}$, Theorem 8.7) and the two-subspace Grassmann relaxation (Proposition 8.8).

7. **Cut-cone evaluation, random-order set capacity, and why column classes cannot absorb per-entry cut labels (Section 9).** On frozen trace/cut fibres of `Transpose.TM`, Lemma 9.1 constructs depth-D symbolic `CausalConeTree`s directly from $M.\delta$ whose syntactic input-cell support has size at most $b(M.k+1)^D$. Theorem 9.3 formalizes in Lean the $1/(\Delta+1)$ random-order acyclic-subgraph bound of [4, Proposition 4.14(a)–(b)] (after [1, Theorem 3]) in the column-class setting. Finally, Remark 9.5 and Proposition 9.6 explain why neither discarding cut-touching outputs nor refining column classes by per-column cut slots yields a non-vacuous sweep bound: causal spine edges $u \to u+1$ force at least $d^2 - D$ outputs to touch the cut, while column-level cut slots multiply the class count exponentially, showing why bridging periodic stretches requires the per-position fixed-alphabet form of [3, Problem 9.4(b)].

1.3 Formalization conventions

Every numbered theorem, lemma, proposition, corollary, and example in this paper is completely proved and kernel-verified in Lean 4 (version `v4.34.1` with Mathlib [14]) across the `BoundedArityDecoders` package and the shared `LeanMachine.ShuffleShear` modules in `lean-machine`, depending solely on Lean's three standard axioms (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`), with zero `sorry`, `admit`, `native_decide`, or custom axioms. Each numbered result carries a `Lean`: status line citing proved `theorem` declarations, followed by an outline of the formal proof.

2 Model and preliminaries

2.1 Matrix states, class-uniform operators, and bounded-arity set codes

For $d \geq 1$, write $\mathbb{Z}_d = \mathbb{Z}/d\mathbb{Z}$ (formalized as `ZModd`). Given an entry alphabet or module A, a $d \times d$ matrix state is a map $X : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to A$, written $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$ or $A^{d\times d}$ (`SharedDecoders.State`). Its transpose $\tau(X) = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ (`SharedDecoders.swap`, or `SharedDecoders.swapLinear` when A is an F-module) and column-cyclic shift $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ for $c \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ (`SharedDecoders.rot`) are defined by

$$\tau(X)_{i,j} \;=\; X_{j,i}, \qquad \mathrm{rot}_c(X)_{i,j} \;=\; X_{i,\,j+c} \qquad (i,j \in \mathbb{Z}_d).$$

Thus column 0 of $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ is column c of X, whereas column c of $\tau(X)$ is the vector $r \mapsto X_{c,r}$ (row c of X).

When $A = F^b$ (`Finb->F`) over a field F, a linear operator $K : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ is *class-uniform* for a column partition $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$ (`SharedDecoders.ClassUniform`; cf. [3, Definition 6.3] and [8, Section 2]) if there exist class decoders $f_m : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to (F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ $(m \in \kappa)$ such that column c of $K(X)$ equals $f_{p(c)}(\mathrm{rot}_c(X))$ for every X and every $c \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ (on the full ambient space, linearity of K automatically allows each active f_m to be chosen F-linear). On a proper subspace $C \le \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$, however, decoder linearity is an extra hypothesis: `SharedDecoders.IsSharedCode` ([8, Definition 2.1]) restricts C to an F-linear submodule while allowing arbitrary deterministic maps f_m.

For the one-stage linear capacity bounds of Sections 5 and 6, we write `laneRot` for the column-rotation map $\mathrm{rot}_s(X)_{i,j} = X_{i,j+s}$ on `Matrix(ZModd)(ZModd)(Finb->F)`. An F-linear submodule $\mathcal{X} \le \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ is a *b-lane linear class-uniform code* for $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$ (`IsLinearClassUniformCode`) if there exist F-linear decoders $\mathcal{A}_m : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to (F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ $(m \in \kappa)$ such that

$$X_{c,r} \;=\; \mathcal{A}_{p(c)}\big(\mathrm{rot}_c(X)\big)_r \qquad \text{for all } X \in \mathcal{X} \text{ and all } c, r \in \mathbb{Z}_d$$

(here c indexes row c of X, i.e. output column c of $\tau(X)$, while rot_c shifts the second index of X). Its maximum dimension over all such subspaces $\mathcal{X}$ is $D_b(p) := \texttt{linearClassUniformMaxDim}(F, b, p)$ (written $D(p) := D_1(p)$ at $b = 1$). For a single shift $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$, the *single-shift link-covariance space* (`ShiftLinkCovarianceSpace`, formulated symmetrically in Lean over two-element shift links $\delta, \delta' \in \{0, s\}$ with $p(c) = p(c')$ and $c + \delta = c' + \delta'$) is

$$H_{\{0,s\}} \;:=\; \Big\{X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \;:\; \forall c \in \mathbb{Z}_d,\; p(c) = p(c+s) \implies \forall j \in \mathbb{Z}_d,\; X_{c+s,j} = X_{c,j+s}\Big\}.$$

We write $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid n$ for the predicate `CoprimeToChar` F n ($\mathrm{char}(F) = 0$ or $\gcd(n, \mathrm{char}(F)) = 1$).

Proposition 2.1 (Linear class-uniform bridges and scalar-extension transfer)**.** Lean: `laneRot_apply` [`ExtensionLinearRun.lean`]
Lean: `extension_LinearModelAndCharBridges` [`ExtensionLinearRunSharpness.lean`]
Lean: `coprimeToChar_iff_natCast_ne_zero`, `exists_isPrimitiveRoot_of_isAlgClosed`, `exists_isPrimitiveRoot_algebraicClosure`, `linearIndependent_fin_pi_ringHom`, `finrank_le_of_pi_ringHom`, `extendLinearMapPi_comp_map` [`ExtensionFieldTransfer.lean`]
Let F be a field and let $d \ge 1$ and $b \in \mathbb{N}$.

(a) At $b = 1$ and for any class type κ, pushing forward along `laneOneMatrixEquiv` *identifies* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$ with* `SwapRigidity.IsClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$ ([3, Definition 6.3]), intertwines* `laneRot` *s with* `SwapRigidity.rot` *s, and preserves both $\dim_F \mathcal{X}$ and $\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}))$. For arbitrary b, pushing forward along* `matrixToSharedStateEquiv` *embeds every* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *into* `SharedDecoders.IsSharedCode` *([8, Definition 2.1]) and intertwines* `laneRot` *s with* `SharedDecoders.rot` *s; moreover, $\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}) \le H_{\{0,s\}}$ for every $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$.*

(b) For every $n \ge 1$, `CoprimeToChar`*(F, n) holds if and only if $(n : F) \ne 0$, in which case every algebraically closed extension of F—and in particular $\overline{F}$ (*`AlgebraicClosureF`*)—contains a primitive n-th root of unity.*

(c) For every field homomorphism $\varphi : F \to K$, coordinatewise application of φ preserves linear independence of finite vector families in F^ι for any index type ι, satisfies $\dim_F U \le \dim_K W$ for any finite ι whenever $U \le F^\iota$ and $W \le K^\iota$ obey $\varphi(U) \subseteq W$, and for finite ι and arbitrary κ' extends every F-linear map $L : F^\iota \to F^{\kappa'}$ to a K-linear map `extendLinearMapPi`*$(\varphi, L) : K^\iota \to K^{\kappa'}$ commuting with coordinatewise application of φ.*

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), `laneOneMatrixEquiv` drops the unique coordinate $0 \in \operatorname{Fin} 1$ and `matrixToSharedStateEquiv` unfolds $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ to $\mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} b \to F$; if $X \in \mathcal{X}$ and $\mathrm{rot}_s(X) \in \mathcal{X}$ with $p(c) = p(c+s) = m$, then $X_{c+s,j} = \mathcal{A}_m(\mathrm{rot}_{c+s}(X))_j = \mathcal{A}_m(\mathrm{rot}_c(\mathrm{rot}_s(X)))_j = \mathrm{rot}_s(X)_{c,j} = X_{c,j+s}$. In (b), $(n : F) = 0$ iff $\mathrm{char}(F) \mid n$; when $(n : F) \neq 0$, $Z^n - 1$ has n distinct roots in $\overline{F}$ ($nZ^{n-1} \neq 0$ at every root), and partitioning those roots by exact multiplicative order across divisors $m \mid n$ with at most $\varphi(m)$ elements per divisor forces $\varphi(n) \geq 1$ primitive n-th roots via $\sum_{m|n} \varphi(m) = n$. In (c), preservation of linear independence is proved by induction on the family size via Gaussian pivot elimination over F at a nonzero coordinate, and `extendLinearMapPi` expands L in the standard basis of F^ι. □

For arbitrary subsets $C \subseteq \Sigma^{d\times d}$ over a finite alphabet Σ (used in Section 9), we also record syntactic cell footprints:

Definition 2.2 (Syntactic read footprints and bounded-arity shared set codes)**.** Let $d \geq 1$, let $M, \Delta \in \mathbb{N}$, and let Σ be a finite alphabet.

(a) A family of class decoders $f : \operatorname{Fin} M \to \Sigma^{d\times d} \to \Sigma^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ has *syntactic cell support* $\leq \Delta$ with footprint table $Q : \operatorname{Fin} M \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Finset}(\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d)$ (`SyntacticCellSupport`) if $|Q_{m,r}| \leq \Delta$ for all (m, r), and whenever $Y_1, Y_2 \in \Sigma^{d\times d}$ agree on every cell $q \in Q_{m,r}$, one has $f_m(Y_1)_r = f_m(Y_2)_r$. (Its whole-column analogue is `SyntacticColumnSupport`.)

(b) Given $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M$, a broken-output set $\mathcal{E} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d$ (indexed by output coordinates (r, c) of $\tau(X)_{r,c} = X_{c,r}$), and $C \subseteq \Sigma^{d\times d}$, the data $(\Delta, p, \mathcal{E}, f, Q)$ form a *bounded-arity shared set code on* C (`IsBoundedAritySetCode`) if (f, Q) has syntactic cell support $\leq \Delta$ and

$$f_{p(c)}\big(\mathrm{rot}_c(X)\big)_r \;=\; X_{c,r} \qquad \text{for all } X \in C \text{ and all } (r, c) \notin \mathcal{E}.$$

2.2 Multitape Turing machines, canonical words, and grid bridges

In Sections 8 and 9 we interface with the multitape Turing machine model `Transpose.TM` imported unchanged from [5, Sections 2.1–2.2 and Definition 2.1]: a machine M has state set $\operatorname{Fin}(M.q + 1)$, work alphabet $\operatorname{Fin}(M.g + 1)$, $M.k$ two-way read-write work tapes, a two-way read-only binary input tape of length $L = d^2 b$ where $b =$ `Transpose.entryBits`(d), and a one-way write-only binary output tape. The canonical word alphabet (`CanonicalWordAlphabet`) is $\Sigma_d := \{0,1\}^b$ (`Fin(Transpose.entryBitsd)->Bool`).

Lemma 2.3 (Canonical word width and dummy-tape padding)**.** Lean: `entryBits_eq_clog` [NativeSweepInterfaceProofs.lean]; Lean: `canonicalWordAlphabet_card_and_ge_two` [SetCapacityConsequences.lean]; Lean: `padDummyWorkTape_transposesWithin` [MachineSweepConsequences.lean]

For every $d \geq 0$, $2 \leq |\Sigma_d|$, and for every $d \geq 2$, `Transpose.entryBits`$(d) = \lceil \log_2 d \rceil$ *and* $|\Sigma_d| = 2^{\lceil \log_2 d \rceil}$*. Moreover, for every time bound $T : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N}$ and every machine M satisfying* `Transpose.TransposesWithin` $M\ T$*, there exists a machine M^+ with $1 \leq M^+.k$ that also satisfies* `Transpose.TransposesWithin` $M^+\ T$*.*

Outline of the formal proof. Since $1 \leq$ `Transpose.entryBits`(d) for all d, $|\Sigma_d| = 2^b \geq 2$, and for $d \geq 2$ the definition $\lfloor \log_2(d-1) \rfloor + 1$ agrees with `Nat.clog`$(2, d)$. When $M.k = 0$, adjoining a single blank work tape whose head never moves preserves states, input-head positions, and emitted output bits step for step. □

To connect Boolean tape matrices $A :$ `Transpose.Matrix` (read on $d \times d$ entries at canonical bit-width $b =$ `Transpose.entryBits`(d)) with the linear operators of Section 8, `encodeTMMatrixToGrid` maps each bit $A(r, c, \ell) \in \{0, 1\}$ to $0, 1 \in F$ in `GridState`$(F, d, b) = (\operatorname{Fin} d \to \operatorname{Fin} d \to \operatorname{Fin} b \to F)$.

Proposition 2.4 (Equivariance of the matrix-to-grid bridge)**.** Lean: `tmMatrix_gridLinear_bridges` [`ShuffleShearBridge.lean`]

For every ring F, `encodeTMMatrixToGrid` *intertwines* `stoneShuffleTMMatrix` *with* `stoneShuffleGridLinear` *(for $d = 2^m, m \geq 0$),* `stoneUnshuffleTMMatrix` *with* `stoneUnshuffleGridLinear` *(for $d = 2^m, m \geq 0$),* `rowShearTMMatrix` *with* `rowShearLinear` *(for $d \geq 1$), and* `Transpose.transpose` *with* `gridSwapLinear`*.*

Outline of the formal proof. Verified directly by unfolding `encodeTMMatrixToGrid` on each coordinate permutation. □

3 Affine Hilbert cubes and Ramsey-free two-stage cutoffs

3.1 Common-message growth on ordered operator cubes

Suppose two F-linear class-uniform operators $K_1, K_2 : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ with class partitions $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M_1$ and $p_2 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M_2$ satisfy $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$. By the common-message reduction of [8, Lemma 6.1 and Theorem 6.3], any such factorization produces a subspace $W \leq A$ of dimension $\dim_F W = bd$ inside a q-channel cyclic shift module $A = (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F^q)$ with $q \leq bM_2$ ($\dim_F A = qd \leq bM_2 d$), together with a linear readout $L : A \to Z$ injective on W such that $L(T_c w) = L(w)$ for all $w \in W$ and all c in a single p_1-class $J = p_1^{-1}(m_1)$ (where $(T_s w)_u = w_{u+s}$, formalized as `cyclicChannelShift`). In [8, Theorem 6.3], choosing a monochromatic arithmetic progression $\{c_0 + js : 0 \leq j < \ell\} \subseteq J$ gave $\ell \dim_F W \leq \dim_F A + (\ell - 1)\dim_F \ker(T_s - \mathrm{id})$, yielding $d \leq M_2(\mathsf{W}(M_1, M_2 + 1) - 1)$.

To dispense with arithmetic progressions over an arbitrary field F, consider any k linear endomorphisms $R_0, \ldots, R_{k-1} \in \mathrm{End}_F(A)$ (not required to commute) and define for each $\varepsilon \in \{0,1\}^k$ the ordered operator cube product (`orderedCubeMap`)

$$R^{\varepsilon} \;:=\; R_{k-1}^{\varepsilon_{k-1}} \cdots R_0^{\varepsilon_0} \in \mathrm{End}_F(A).$$

Lemma 3.1 (Affine k-cube common-message growth)**.** Lean: `lemma_AffineCubeCommonMessageGrowth` [`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`]

Let F be any field, A a finite-dimensional F-vector space, Z an F-vector space, $R_0, \ldots, R_{k-1} \in \mathrm{End}_F(A)$, $W \leq A$ a subspace, and $L : A \to Z$ an F-linear map injective on W. If $L(R^{\varepsilon} x) = L(x)$ for all $x \in W$ and all $\varepsilon \in \{0,1\}^k$, then

$$(k+1)\dim_F W \;\leq\; \dim_F A \;+\; \sum_{t=0}^{k-1} \dim_F \ker(R_t - \mathrm{id}_A).$$

Outline of the formal proof. Define the nested cube-orbit subspaces $S_0 := W$ and $S_{t+1} := S_t + R_t(S_t)$ for $0 \leq t < k$. By induction on t, every $u \in S_t$ is a linear combination of elements $R^{\varepsilon} x$ with $x \in W$ and $\varepsilon_s = 0$ for $s \geq t$. Comparing $\varepsilon_t = 1$ with $\varepsilon_t = 0$ in the cube invariance $L(R^{\varepsilon} x) = L(x)$ shows that $P_t := R_t - \mathrm{id}_A$ maps S_t into $S_{t+1} \cap \ker L$. Since $W \subseteq S_t \subseteq S_{t+1}$ and L is injective on W, we have $W \cap P_t(S_t) \subseteq W \cap \ker L = \{0\}$, so

$$\dim_F S_{t+1} \;\geq\; \dim_F W + \dim_F P_t(S_t) \;\geq\; \dim_F W + \dim_F S_t - \dim_F \ker(R_t - \mathrm{id}_A).$$

Summing from $t = 0$ to $k - 1$ gives $(k+1)\dim_F W \leq \dim_F S_k + \sum_{t=0}^{k-1} \dim_F \ker(R_t - \mathrm{id}_A) \leq \dim_F A + \sum_{t=0}^{k-1} \dim_F \ker(R_t - \mathrm{id}_A)$. □

3.2 Iterated Cauchy–Schwarz cube extraction and Theorem 2A

Unlike arithmetic progressions, affine k-cubes exist in every dense subset $J \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$ (including 3-AP-free sets) by elementary bucket pigeonholing and Cauchy–Schwarz, with explicit step bounds $1 \le s_t \le \lfloor d/(2k^2) \rfloor$ keeping $\dim_F \ker(T_{s_t} - \mathrm{id})$ small.

Lemma 3.2 (Cauchy–Schwarz affine k-cube extraction and dense-class bound)**.** Lean: `cauchySchwarzAffineCubeExtraction` [`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`]
Lean: `singleSubset_CauchySchwarzAffineCubeExtraction`, `denseSubset_AffineCubeCommonMessageBound` [`AffineCubeConsequences.lean`]
Let $d, M_{\mathrm{eff}}, k \ge 1$ satisfy $\max(8M_{\mathrm{eff}}k^2,\ (2M_{\mathrm{eff}})^{2^k}) < d$.

(a) Single-subset form*: for every subset $J \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$ of size $|J| \ge d/M_{\mathrm{eff}}$, there exist $c_0 \in J$ and steps $s_0, \dots, s_{k-1} \in \{1, \dots, \lfloor d/(2k^2) \rfloor\}$ such that $c_0 + \sum_{t:\varepsilon_t=1} s_t \in J$ for all $\varepsilon \in \{0,1\}^k$. Over any field F, any subspace $W \le (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F^q)$ admitting an F-linear readout $L : (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F^q) \to Z$ into an F-vector space Z and a reference shift $c_{\mathrm{ref}} \in J$ such that $w \mapsto L(T_{c_{\mathrm{ref}}} w)$ is injective on W and $L(T_c w) = L(T_{c_{\mathrm{ref}}} w)$ for all $c \in J$ and all $w \in W$ satisfies $(k+1)\dim_F W \le qd + qk\lfloor d/(2k^2) \rfloor$, ruling out exact two-stage linear factorizations (for any stage-1 class type κ_1) whenever one stage-1 class has size $\ge d/M_{\mathrm{eff}}$ at $k = M_2$ and $b \ge 1$.*

(b) Coloring form*: setting $M_{\mathrm{eff}} = M_1$ and $k = M_2$, every M_1-coloring $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M_1$ admits a monochromatic affine M_2-cube with steps in $\{1, \dots, \lfloor d/(2M_2^2) \rfloor\}$.*

Outline of the formal proof. Lift J to $S_0 \subseteq \{0, \dots, d-1\}$. Partitioning $\{0, \dots, d-1\}$ into $Q = 2k^2$ intervals of length $\le \lfloor d/Q \rfloor + 1$ and applying Cauchy–Schwarz to the bucket sizes shows that for any $S \subseteq \{0, \dots, d-1\}$ with $|S| > Q$, some step $s \in \{1, \dots, \lfloor d/Q \rfloor\}$ satisfies $|S|(|S| - Q) \le 2d\,|\{x \in S : x + s \in S \text{ in } \mathbb{N}\}|$. Iterating k times with $D_0 = M_{\mathrm{eff}}$ and $D_{t+1} = 2D_t^2$ ($D_k = \frac{1}{2}(2M_{\mathrm{eff}})^{2^k}$) maintains $|S_t| \ge d/D_t - Q/2$ for $1 \le t < k$, so $d > \max(8M_{\mathrm{eff}}k^2, (2M_{\mathrm{eff}})^{2^k})$ keeps $|S_{k-1}| > Q$ and $|S_k| \ge 1$. Because each step filters $x + s_t \in S_t$ in $\mathbb{N}$ inside $S_0 \subseteq \{0, \dots, d-1\}$, every cube sum $x_0 + \sum_{t:\varepsilon_t=1} s_t$ ($x_0 \in S_k$) lies in S_0 with natural sum $< d$, preventing wraparound modulo d. Feeding the extracted cube into Lemma 3.1 with $\dim_F \ker(T_{s_t} - \mathrm{id}) \le q s_t \le q\lfloor d/(2k^2) \rfloor$ gives the dimension bound. □

Theorem 3.3 (Theorem 2A: Ramsey-free two-stage exact factorization cutoff)**.** Lean: `theorem2A_TwoStageRamseyFreeCutoff` [`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`]
Lean: `theorem2A_GrowingClassesNonFactorization` [`AffineCubeConsequences.lean`]
Let F be any field, let $d, b, M_1, M_2 \ge 1$, and let $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M_1$ and $p_2 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M_2$. If two F-linear class-uniform maps K_1, K_2 on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ satisfy $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$, then

$$d \ \le\ \max\Big(8M_1M_2^2,\ (2M_1)^{2^{M_2}}\Big)$$

(giving $d \le \max(8M_1, 4M_1^2)$ when $M_2 = 1$). Consequently, for any $b \ge 1$ and any class schedules $M_1(d), M_2(d) \ge 1$ eventually satisfying both $8M_1(d)M_2(d)^2 < d$ and $(2M_1(d))^{2^{M_2(d)}} < d$ (for instance, fixed $M_2 \ge 1$ with $M_1(d) = o(d^{1/2^{M_2}})$, covering 3-AP-free Behrend partitions [2] with $M_1(d) = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$, or fixed $M_1 \ge 1$ and fixed $\varepsilon \in (0,1)$ with $M_2(d) \le (1-\varepsilon)\log_2\log_2 d$), for all sufficiently large d no exact two-stage linear factorization $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ exists over any field F.

Outline of the formal proof. Assume for contradiction that $\max(8M_1M_2^2, (2M_1)^{2^{M_2}}) < d$ and $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$. By Lemma 3.2(b), some p_1-class contains an affine M_2-cube with steps $1 \le s_t \le \lfloor d/(2M_2^2) \rfloor$.

On the q-channel common-message module $A = (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F^q)$ ($q \le bM_2$, $\dim_F A = qd \le bM_2 d$), [8, Lemma 6.1 and Theorem 6.3] supplies a subspace $W \le A$ of dimension $\dim_F W = bd$ while $\dim_F \ker(T_{s_t} - \mathrm{id}) \le qs_t \le bM_2 \lfloor d/(2M_2^2) \rfloor$. Applying Lemma 3.1 with $k = M_2$ gives

$$(M_2+1)bd \;\le\; bM_2 d + \sum_{t=0}^{M_2-1} bM_2 \lfloor d/(2M_2^2) \rfloor \;\le\; bM_2 d + \frac{1}{2} bd,$$

contradicting $bd > 0$. □

Remark 3.4 (Comparison with van der Waerden cutoffs at small parameters)**.** Theorem 3.3 trades small-parameter tightness for elementary dependence on M_1. At $M_1 = M_2 = 2$, Theorem 3.3 gives $d \le \max(64, 4^4) = 256$, which is substantially weaker than the bound $d \le 2(9-1) = 16$ (using $\mathsf{W}(2,3) \le 9$) of [8, Corollary 6.4]. Conversely, [8, Theorem 6.3] supplies no quantitative upper bound on $\mathsf{W}(M_1, M_2+1)$ beyond qualitative Hales–Jewett finiteness [10], and progression extraction of length $M_2 + 1 \ge 3$ cannot rule out 3-AP-free Behrend partitions [2] with $M_1(d) = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$, whereas Theorem 3.3 gives an explicit cutoff polynomial in M_1 for every fixed M_2.

3.3 Finite controls at $d = 13$ and $d = 4$

Two finite-dimensional examples test the linear-growth multiplier $(k+1)$ in Lemma 3.1 and the coded-versus-copy distinction at $d = 4 = M_1 M_2$.

Example 3.5 (3-AP-free 2-cube witness at $d = 13$)**.** Lean: `control_D13TwoCubeAPFreeSharpness` [`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`]
Lean: `control_D13_GeneralFieldAndProgressionBridge` [`AffineCubeConsequences.lean`]
Let $d = 13$, $q = 2$ ($\dim_F A = 26$), and consider the 2-cube $J_{13} = \{0,1,4,5\} = \{0,1\} + \{0,4\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{13}$.

(a) J_{13} is 3-AP-free modulo 13 (`ThreeAPFreeMod`), so every non-constant progression in J_{13} has length $\ell \le 2$, where the single-step progression bound gives only $\dim_F W \le 14$ (attained on $\{0,1\}$ over every field).

(b) Over every field F, Lemma 3.1 with $k = 2$ and $\dim_F \ker(T_s - \mathrm{id}) = 2$ ($s \in \{1,4\}$) gives $3 \dim_F W \le 26 + 2 + 2 = 30$, hence $\dim_F W \le 10$.

(c) Over $\mathbb{R}$, and over every field F with $(13 : F) \ne 0$, there exists an explicit (W, L) shift-invariant on J_{13} of dimension $\dim_F W = 9$. Thus the maximum invariant dimension on J_{13} over such fields lies in $\{9, 10\}$; by contrast, on every non-constant 4-term arithmetic progression in $\mathbb{Z}_{13}$ the progression bound forces $4 \dim_F W \le 26 + 3 \cdot 2 = 32$ ($\dim_F W \le 8 < 9$), and a naive 2^k-multiplier inequality $2^k \dim_F W \le \dim_F A + (2^k - 1)q$ fails at $k = 2$.

Outline of the formal proof. Residue inspection verifies that J_{13} has no non-constant 3-term progression modulo 13, and cyclic shift periodicity gives $\dim_F \ker(T_s - \mathrm{id}) = 2$ for every $s \ne 0$ in $\mathbb{Z}_{13}$. Conceptually, the constant mode contributes 2 dimensions and 7 nonzero Fourier modes each satisfy a rank-3 alignment system inside a 4-dimensional mode space ($2 + 7 = 9$); in Lean, over every field F with $(13 : F) \ne 0$, explicit integer matrices $E \in \mathbb{Z}^{26 \times 9}$ and $L_{13} \in \mathbb{Z}^{9 \times 26}$ satisfy $L_{13}(T_c E) = 13 I_9$ for all $c \in J_{13}$, directly certifying both $\dim_F W = 9$ and shift-invariant injectivity of L_{13}. □

Example 3.6 (Same-interval coded factorizations at $d = 4 = M_1M_2$ when $(5 : F) \neq 0$)**.** Lean: `control_D4SameIntervalCodedFactorization` [`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`]
Lean: `control_D4_AllWidthsAndBinaryFields` [`AffineCubeConsequences.lean`]

Let $d = 4$ and let both stages use the same two-interval partition $p_1 = p_2 = [0, 0, 1, 1]$ (`halfInterv alPartition4`, $M_1 = M_2 = 2$).

(a) *Uncoded impossibility*: for every lane width $b \geq 1$ and finite alphabet $|\Sigma| \geq 2$, neither entry-copy rules nor bit-lane-copy rules K_1, K_2 with $p_1 = p_2 = [0, 0, 1, 1]$ can satisfy $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$.

(b) *Coded factorization for* $(5 : F) \neq 0$: over every field F with $(5 : F) \neq 0$ (combining an explicit rational table valid whenever $(20 : F) \neq 0$ with a separate binary 0/1 table valid whenever $(2 : F) = 0$, including $\mathbb{F}_2$ at $b = 1$), and for every lane width $b \geq 0$, there exist F-linear class-uniform maps K_1, K_2 on $\mathrm{Mat}_{4\times4}(F^b)$ with $p_1 = p_2 = [0, 0, 1, 1]$ satisfying $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$. (Whether such a factorization exists in characteristic 5 for $b \geq 1$ is not decided here.)

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), because stage 2 can route across distinct bit lanes, the proof argues on all $4b$ wires $\mathbb{Z}_4 \times \mathrm{Fin}\, b$ simultaneously: comparing columns $c = 0$ and $c = 1$ ($p_2(0) = p_2(1) = 0$) on two-symbol test inputs shows that for every wire $q = (i, \ell)$, stage 2's shift $u_2(0, i, \ell)$ lies in $\{1, 3\}$ and stage 1's source row on $\varphi_0(q) := (r_2(0, i, \ell), \ell_2(0, i, \ell))$ lies in $\{0, 1\}$, and moreover φ_0 is injective and hence surjective on $\mathbb{Z}_4 \times \mathrm{Fin}\, b$; thus stage 1 can never output input row 2, contradicting column $c = 2$. In (b), separate explicit linear tables verify $K_2 \circ K_1 = \tau$ lane-by-lane when $(20 : F) \neq 0$ and when $(2 : F) = 0$; every field with $(5 : F) \neq 0$ satisfies one of the two conditions. □

4 Shifted sumsets and logarithmic two-stage rank deficits

4.1 Minimum-shifted monochromatic sumsets

For approximate two-stage compositions at fixed class counts $M_1, M_2 \geq 1$, write

$$r \;:=\; \mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1).$$

In [8, Theorem 6.6], extracting a monochromatic progression of length $\ell = (2M_2+1)k-1$ inside p_1 gave $r \geq bk(d - N_0 + 1)/2$ with $N_0 = \mathsf{W}(M_1, \ell)$ over every field F with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ ($(d : F) \neq 0$), proving $r/(bd) \to \infty$ as $d \to \infty$. Because [8, Theorem 6.6] uses qualitative finiteness of $\mathsf{W}(M_1, \ell)$ via the Hales–Jewett theorem [10] without a quantitative bound on W (and even the longest monochromatic progression in a 2-coloring of $\mathbb{Z}_d$ has worst-case length $O(\log d)$, or < 3 at $M_1 = 2^{O(\sqrt{\log d})}$ by [2]), it does not supply an explicit growth rate for $r/(bd)$.

Over any field F in which d is invertible ($(d : F) \neq 0$), we pass to a splitting field E/F carrying an injective additive character $\chi : \mathbb{Z}_d \to E^\times$ and replace progressions by $(n+1)$-fold monochromatic sumsets at $n = 2M_2 - 1$: an *unshifted* $(n+1)$-fold monochromatic sumset in class m_1 consists of a base set $J_0 \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$ ($|J_0| = k$) and n natural-number shift sets $B_0, \ldots, B_{n-1} \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ ($|B_t| = k + 1$) whose cast sumset in $\mathbb{Z}_d$ satisfies

$$J_0 + B_0 + \cdots + B_{n-1} \;\subseteq\; p_1^{-1}(m_1).$$

For any finite $S \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, write $\mathrm{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(S) := \max S - \min S$ (0 if $S = \emptyset$; `finsetNatDiam`). Shifting each B_t down by $\min B_t$ places $0 \in \widetilde{B}_t$ while preserving $\mathrm{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}_t) = \mathrm{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(B_t)$, producing a *shifted* $(n+1)$-fold monochromatic sumset $(\widetilde{J}_0, \widetilde{B}, \mathrm{diamB})$ ($|\widetilde{J}_0| = k$, $0 \in \widetilde{B}_t \subseteq [0, \mathrm{diamB}_t] \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, $|\widetilde{B}_t| = k+1$, and $\widetilde{J}_0 + \sum_{t=0}^{n-1} \widetilde{B}_t \subseteq p_1^{-1}(m_1)$) so that all partial subset sums remain in $p_1^{-1}(m_1)$ simultaneously.

Lemma 4.1 (Minimum-shifting monochromatic sumsets)**.** Lean: `unshiftedToShiftedSumset` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]

Lean: `finsetNatDiam_shift_min`, `unshiftedToShiftedSumset_intrinsicDiam` [`SumsetRankConsequences.lean`]

Let $d, M_1 \geq 1$ and $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_1$. Given any unshifted monochromatic sumset $J_0 + B_0 + \cdots + B_{n-1} \subseteq p_1^{-1}(m_1)$ ($J_0 \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$, $B_t \subseteq \mathbb{N}$) with $|J_0| = k$, $|B_t| = k+1$, and $B_t \subseteq [0, L_0]$, setting $\widetilde{B}_t := B_t - \min B_t$ and $\widetilde{J}_0 := J_0 + \sum_{t=0}^{n-1} \min B_t$ satisfies $0 \in \widetilde{B}_t$, $|\widetilde{B}_t| = k+1$, $\operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}_t) = \operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(B_t) \leq L_0$, $|\widetilde{J}_0| = k$, and

$$\widetilde{J}_0 + \sum_{t \in S} \widetilde{B}_t \;\subseteq\; p_1^{-1}(m_1) \qquad \text{for every subset } S \subseteq \{0, \ldots, n-1\}$$

(packaged directly at $n = 2M_2 - 1$ with $\operatorname{diamB}_t = \operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(B_t)$ for $M_2 \geq 1$ in `unshiftedToShiftedSumset_intrinsicDiam`*).*

Outline of the formal proof. Choosing $b_t \in \widetilde{B}_t$ for $t \in S$ and $0 \in \widetilde{B}_t$ for $t \notin S$ rewrites $c_0 + \sum_{t=0}^{n-1} \min B_t + \sum_{t \in S} b_t = c_0 + \sum_{t=0}^{n-1} (b_t + \min B_t)$ with $b_t + \min B_t \in B_t$. Translation by $-\min B_t$ on $\mathbb{N}_{\geq \min B_t}$ preserves both cardinality and $\max - \min$. □

4.2 Arbitrary-subset Vandermonde pullback and sparse annihilating polynomials

On an arbitrary k-element subset $J_0 \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$, the character-evaluation matrix $\big(\chi(\nu \cdot c)\big)_{c \in J_0,\, 0 \leq \nu < k}$ is a $k \times k$ Vandermonde matrix in the k distinct scalars $z_c = \chi(c)$ ($c \in J_0$), since $\chi(\nu \cdot c) = \chi(c)^\nu$. Thus J_0 need not be an interval or progression for stacked evaluation on the frequency-$< k$ band to be injective. Following [8, Section 6], for a partition $p_2 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_2$ and $k \leq d$, let $H :=$ `SharedDecoders.bandRowSpace` $(\chi, p_2, k) \leq (E^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ be the E-span of the bM_2k class-modulated character vectors $i \mapsto \mathbf{1}_{p_2(i) = m_2}\, \chi(\nu i)\, e_\ell$ ($m_2 \in \operatorname{Fin} M_2$, $0 \leq \nu < k$, $\ell \in \operatorname{Fin} b$, so $\dim_E H \leq bM_2k$), and let `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient`$(H) = (\mathrm{Unit} \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to H) \cong (\mathbb{Z}_d \to H)$ embed into $\operatorname{Mat}_{d \times d}(E^b)$ via $(\iota_H x)_{i,c} = (x_{(),c})_i$ (`SharedDecoders.columnAmbientEmbed`), with column shift $(T_{\mathrm{band}} x)_{(),c} = x_{(),c+1}$ (`SharedDecoders.channelRotation` at shift 1) satisfying $\iota_H(T_{\mathrm{band}} x) = \mathrm{rot}_1(\iota_H x)$.

Lemma 4.2 (Arbitrary-subset Vandermonde injectivity and stacked band pullback)**.** Lean: `vandermondeArbitrarySubsetInjective`, `stackedBandPullbackInjective` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]

Let $d \geq 1$, let E be a field with an injective additive character $\chi : \mathbb{Z}_d \to E^\times$, and let $J_0 \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$ satisfy $|J_0| = k \leq d$.

(a) For any E-vector space V, degree-$< k$ character evaluation $a \mapsto \big(\sum_{\nu=0}^{k-1} \chi(\nu c)\, a_\nu\big)_{c \in J_0}$ (`charBandEval`*) is injective on V^k.*

(b) Let $M_1, M_2 \geq 1$, $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_1$, and $p_2 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_2$. For any two E-linear class-uniform stages K_1, K_2 on $\operatorname{Mat}_{d \times d}(E^b)$ with $J_0 \subseteq p_1^{-1}(m_1)$ and stage-1 class-m_1 decoder f_{1,m_1}, the frequency-$< k$ band space H (`SharedDecoders.bandRowSpace` *at (χ, p_2, k), with $\dim_E H \leq bM_2k$) carries a pullback subspace $W \leq$ `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient`(H) satisfying*

$$\dim_E W + \operatorname{rank}_E(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \;\geq\; bkd$$

such that the stacked evaluation $x \mapsto \big(f_{1,m_1}(\mathrm{rot}_c(\iota_H x))\big)_{c \in J_0}$ is injective on W.

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), $\chi(\nu c) = \chi(c)^\nu$, and injectivity of χ makes $\{\chi(c) : c \in J_0\}$ k distinct scalars in E, so a degree-$< k$ vector-valued polynomial vanishing on J_0 is zero. Part (b) restricts $\tau - K_2 \circ K_1$ to inputs whose columns lie in the k-frequency character subspace (bkd dimensions), intersects with $\ker(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)$ losing at most $r = \operatorname{rank}_E(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)$ dimensions, and applies (a) to deduce that vanishing of $K_1 X$ on columns $c \in J_0$ forces $(\tau X)_{:,c} = (K_2 K_1 X)_{:,c} = 0$ on J_0 and hence $X = 0$. □

Each summand $\widetilde{B}_t$ of size $k+1$ provides $k+1$ monomials against k frequencies $\nu \in \{0, \dots, k-1\}$, guaranteeing a nonzero sparse polynomial supported in $\widetilde{B}_t$ that annihilates the frequency-$< k$ band and has degree at most $\operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}_t)$.

Lemma 4.3 (Sparse sumset annihilating polynomial)**.** Lean: `sumsetAnnihilatingPolynomial`, `cyclicChannelShift_aeval_ker_finrank_le` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]
Lean: `sumsetAnnihilatingPolynomial_bandRowSpace` [`SumsetRankConsequences.lean`]
Let $d \geq 1$, let E be a field with an additive character $\chi : \mathbb{Z}_d \to E^\times$, and let $\widetilde{B} \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ satisfy $0 \in \widetilde{B}$, $|\widetilde{B}| = k+1$, and $\max \widetilde{B} \leq L_0$. Then there exists a nonzero polynomial $P \in E[Z]$ supported in $\widetilde{B}$ with $\deg P \leq \operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}) \leq L_0$ such that $P(\chi(\nu)) = \sum_{x \in \widetilde{B}} P_x \chi(\nu x) = 0$ for all $0 \leq \nu < k$. Moreover, for any $q \in \mathbb{N}$, on the q-channel cyclic shift module $(\mathbb{Z}_d \to E^q)$ with unit shift $(T_1 w)_c = w_{c+1}$ one has

$$\dim_E \ker P(T_1) \;\leq\; q \,\deg P \;\leq\; q\, L_0,$$

and on `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient` *over* `SharedDecoders.bandRowSpace` *for (χ, p_2, k) (where $\dim_E H \leq bM_2k$) one has $\dim_E \ker P(T_{\mathrm{band}}) \leq bM_2kL_0$.*

Outline of the formal proof. The homogeneous linear system $\sum_{x \in \widetilde{B}} P_x \chi(\nu x) = 0$ $(0 \leq \nu < k)$ has k equations in $k+1$ unknowns, hence a nonzero solution P supported in $\widetilde{B}$ of degree $\leq \max \widetilde{B} = \operatorname{diam}_{\mathbb{N}}(\widetilde{B}) \leq L_0$. On $(\mathbb{Z}_d \to E^q)$, the linear recurrence $P(T_1)w = 0$ determines w from at most $\deg P$ coordinates once $\deg P \leq d$ (and trivially $\dim \leq qd \leq q \deg P$ when $\deg P > d$). □

4.3 Sumset rank bound, Kővári–Sós–Turán extraction, and Theorem 2B

Theorem 4.4 (Two-stage sumset recurrence rank bound)**.** Lean: `sumsetTwoHopRankBound` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]
Let F be a field with $(d : F) \neq 0$, let $M_1, M_2, b \geq 1$, and let $1 \leq k \leq d$. Suppose $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_1$ admits a shifted $(2M_2)$-fold monochromatic sumset $(\widetilde{J}_0, \widetilde{B}, \mathrm{diamB})$ in class m_1 with $\sum_{t=0}^{2M_2-2} \mathrm{diamB}_t \leq d$. Then for every $p_2 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_2$ and every pair of F-linear class-uniform maps K_1, K_2 on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$, writing $r := \operatorname{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)$,

$$2r \;\geq\; bk\Big(d - \sum_{t=0}^{2M_2-2} \mathrm{diamB}_t\Big), \qquad \text{and if } \mathrm{diamB}_t \leq \lfloor d/(4M_2) \rfloor \text{ for all } t, \quad 4r \;\geq\; bkd.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Since $(d : F) \neq 0$, $Z^d - 1$ is separable over F; passing to a cyclotomic splitting field E/F does not increase—indeed preserves—$\operatorname{rank}(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1)$ (`SharedDecoders.stateExtension_rank_le`) and furnishes an injective character $\chi : \mathbb{Z}_d \to E^\times$. Let $W \leq A_{\mathrm{band}}$ $(\dim_E A_{\mathrm{band}} \leq bM_2kd)$ be the pullback subspace from Lemma 4.2(b) on $\widetilde{J}_0$, with $\dim_E W \geq bkd - r$, and let P_t be the sparse annihilating polynomial on $\widetilde{B}_t$ from Lemma 4.3. Because P_t annihilates the frequency-$< k$ band while every shift in $\widetilde{J}_0 + \sum_{s \leq t} \widetilde{B}_s$ lies in $p_1^{-1}(m_1)$, $P_t(T_{\mathrm{band}})$ maps the t-th

partial sumset span U_t into the kernel of stacked $\widetilde{J}_0$-evaluation, which meets W trivially. Each of the $2M_2 - 1$ steps therefore adds at least $\dim_E W - bM_2k \operatorname{diamB}_t$ dimensions inside A_{band}:

$$2M_2 \dim_E W - bM_2k \sum_{t=0}^{2M_2-2} \operatorname{diamB}_t \;\le\; \dim_E A_{\text{band}} \;\le\; bM_2kd.$$

Substituting $\dim_E W \ge bkd - r$ and dividing by M_2 yields $2r \ge bk\big(d - \sum_t \operatorname{diamB}_t\big)$, and $\operatorname{diamB}_t \le \lfloor d/(4M_2) \rfloor$ gives $\sum_t \operatorname{diamB}_t \le d/2$, hence $4r \ge bkd$. □

Lemma 4.5 (Iterated Kővári–Sós–Turán monochromatic sumset extraction)**.** Lean: `iteratedKovariSosTuranSumset` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]

For every $M_1, M_2 \ge 1$, there exist $0 < c_{\text{lo}} \le C_{\text{hi}}$ and $D_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $d \ge D_0$, every M_1-coloring $p_1 : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M_1$ contains an unshifted (and hence shifted) $(2M_2)$-fold monochromatic sumset in $\mathbb{Z}_d$ whose $2M_2 - 1$ shift summands B_t (and $\widetilde{B}_t$) lie in $[0, \lfloor d/(4M_2) \rfloor] \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ at width scale $1 \le k \le d$ satisfying

$$c_{\text{lo}} (\log d)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}} \;\le\; k \;\le\; C_{\text{hi}} (\log d)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}}.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Start from the densest color class $A_0 \subseteq \{0, \dots, d-1\}$ ($|A_0| \ge \lceil d/M_1 \rceil$). At each of the $2M_2 - 1$ steps, partition $\{0, \dots, d-1\}$ into $4M_2$ intervals of width at most $\lfloor d/(4M_2) \rfloor + 1$, pick the densest bucket $I \cap A$ of size $m \ge \lceil |A|/(4M_2) \rceil$, split $I \cap A$ into its lower $\lfloor m/2 \rfloor$ and upper $\lceil m/2 \rceil$ elements, and apply the Kővári–Sós–Turán double count [12] to $(k+1)$-tuples of differences $a_{\text{hi}} - a_{\text{lo}} \in [0, \lfloor d/(4M_2) \rfloor]$ (so $a_{\text{lo}} + b = a_{\text{hi}} \in A \subseteq [0, d)$ never wraps modulo d). Iterating $2M_2 - 1$ times extracts k base elements and $2M_2 - 1$ shift sets of size $k+1$ at density cost exponential in k^{2M_2-1}, balancing at $k = \Theta_{M_1,M_2}\big((\log d)^{1/(2M_2-1)}\big)$. □

Theorem 4.6 (Theorem 2B: log-power two-stage rank deficit over admissible fields)**.** Lean: `theorem2B_TwoStageLogPowerRankDeficit` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]

Lean: `theorem2B_ExplicitConstant`, `theorem2BExplicitConst_pos`, `theorem2BExplicitThreshold_eq_pow` [`SumsetRankConsequences.lean`]

For all integers $M_1, M_2 \ge 1$, define the explicit constant and dimension threshold (`theorem2BExplicitConst`*,* `theorem2BExplicitThreshold`*)*

$$\begin{aligned} c(M_1, M_2) \;&:=\; \frac{1}{144\,\big(\log(16M_1M_2)\big)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}}} \;>\; 0, \\ D_0(M_1, M_2) \;&:=\; \max\Big(4M_2,\; \big\lceil \exp\big(36^{2M_2-1} \log(16M_1M_2)\big)\big\rceil + 2\Big) \\ &=\; \max\Big(4M_2,\; (16M_1M_2)^{36^{2M_2-1}} + 2\Big). \end{aligned}$$

Then for every field F, every $d \ge D_0(M_1, M_2)$ with $(d : F) \ne 0$, every lane width $b \ge 1$, and every pair of F-linear class-uniform stages K_1, K_2 on $\operatorname{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ with M_1 and M_2 classes,

$$\operatorname{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \;\ge\; c(M_1, M_2)\, b\, d\, (\log d)^{\frac{1}{2M_2-1}}.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Instantiate the Kővári–Sós–Turán chain of Lemma 4.5 at $k = \big\lfloor \big(\frac{\log d}{18^{2M_2-1} \log(16M_1M_2)}\big)^{1/(2M_2-1)} \big\rfloor \ge 2$ for $d \ge D_0(M_1, M_2)$, and substitute into $4r \ge bkd$ from Theorem 4.4. □

Remark 4.7 (Asymptotic threshold and characteristic restriction)**.** Two limitations of Theorem 4.6 should be noted explicitly. First, the formalized threshold $D_0(M_1, M_2)$ is purely asymptotic: already at $M_1 = M_2 = 1$ one has $D_0(1,1) = 16^{36} + 2 = 2^{144} + 2 \approx 2.23 \times 10^{43}$, and for larger M_2 the exponent 36^{2M_2-1} grows exponentially in M_2. Second, like [8, Theorem 6.6] (and unlike Theorem 3.3), Theorem 4.6 requires $(d : F) \neq 0$ (excluding $\mathbb{F}_2$ at $d = 2^m$) so that $\mathbb{Z}_d$ admits d distinct character values.

Corollary 4.8 (Single-class second stage: $\Omega(b\,d\log d)$ rank deficit)**.** Lean: `theorem2B_OneSecondStage_OmegaLog` [`SumsetRankConsequences.lean`]

When $M_2 = 1$, for every $M_1 \geq 1$ there exist $c > 0$ and $D_0 \geq 2$ such that for every field F, every $d \geq D_0$ with $(d : F) \neq 0$, every $b \geq 1$, and every M_1-class K_1 and 1-class K_2 on $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$,

$$\mathrm{rank}_F(\tau - K_2 \circ K_1) \;\geq\; c\,b\,d\log d.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Specialize Theorem 4.6 to $M_2 = 1$, where $\frac{1}{2M_2-1} = 1$. □

4.4 Abstract band relaxation control at $d = 12$

Theorem 4.4 uses stage-1 class-uniformity across all shifts of a $(2M_2)$-fold sumset rather than relaxing stage 1 to an arbitrary linear readout L on the q-channel ambient space `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient` of H over a single half-density subset $J \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$ and a single $k = 2$ band. The following 4-channel witness at $d = 12$ shows that this abstract relaxation admits full kd-dimensional solutions.

Example 4.9 (Abstract 4-channel band witness at $d = 12$ over $\mathbb{C}$)**.** Lean: `control_D12SingleClassAbstractBand` [`SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`]

Lean: `exists_primitive_twelfth_root_complex`, `d12AddChar_injective_and_primitive`, `control_D12_UnconditionalExists`, `control_D12_BandRowSpaceChannelEquiv` [`SumsetRankConsequences.lean`]

At $d = 12$ and $k = 2$ on the 4-channel cyclic module $(\mathbb{Z}_{12} \to \mathbb{C}^4)$ ($q = 4$, corresponding to scalar lane width $b = 1$ with $M_2 = 2, k = 2$ where $24 = bkd$, or via `control_D12_BandRowSpaceChannelEquiv` to `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient` over `SharedDecoders.bandRowSpace` for $(\chi, p_0, 2)$ (where $p_0 : \mathbb{Z}_{12} \to \mathrm{Fin}\,1$ is the single-class partition) at $b = 2, M_2 = 1, k = 2$ when L reads 12 scalar coordinates per shift), let $J_{12} = \{0, 1, 3, 4, 7, 9\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$ ($|J_{12}| = 6$). With $\zeta_{12} = \exp(2\pi i/12) \in \mathbb{C}$, there exist a linear readout $L : (\mathbb{Z}_{12} \to \mathbb{C}^4) \to \mathbb{C}^{12}$ and a 24-dimensional subspace $W \leq (\mathbb{Z}_{12} \to \mathbb{C}^4)$ on which stacked evaluation over J_{12} is injective and realizes every pair $(a_0, a_1) \in (\mathbb{C}^{12})^2$ as $L(T_c w) = a_0 + \zeta_{12}^c a_1$ for all $c \in J_{12}$.

Outline of the formal proof. Verify that $\zeta_{12} = \exp(2\pi i/12)$ has exact multiplicative order 12 in $\mathbb{C}$, construct the explicit 24-dimensional 4-channel encoding whose shifts on J_{12} output $a_0 + \zeta_{12}^c a_1$, and identify $(\mathbb{Z}_{12} \to \mathbb{C}^4)$ shift-equivariantly with `SharedDecoders.ColumnAmbient` over `SharedDecoders.bandRowSpace` for $(\chi, p_0, 2)$ at $b = 2, M_2 = 1, k = 2$. Because $q = 4$ corresponds to $bM_2 = 2$ rather than $b = M_2 = 1$, this example isolates the failure of the abstract band relaxation when stage-1 shift covariance is dropped, rather than providing an actual $b = 1, M_1 = M_2 = 1$ two-stage factorization. □

5 Run-extension bounds for one-stage linear shared decoders

5.1 Why nonlinear translate certificates stall at $5/8$, and run-extension for linear decoders

We now turn from two-stage compositions to the one-stage linear shared-decoder capacity problem posed in [3, Problem 9.1(a)]: for a partition $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$ into M column classes, bound the maximum dimension $D_b(p) = \texttt{linearClassUniformMaxDim}(F, b, p)$ of an F-linear class-uniform code $\mathcal{X} \le \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b)$ (`IsLinearClassUniformCode`). When each class is a cyclic interval, Theorem TP ([3, Theorem 6.4], Lean-verified) gives $D_1(p) \le (d^2 + Md)/2$, whereas scattered classes can exceed that interval value ([3, Proposition 8.2], Lean-verified, and [7, Theorem 4.9] at $d \in \{8, 12, 16\}$, Lean-verified; [3, Proposition 6.17 and Corollary 6.19] and [7, Theorem 4.8 and Corollary 4.10], proved in text).

Theorem 3.4 of [8] (Lean-verified, as are Theorems 3.2, 3.5, C.6, and C.7 cited below) proved the universal two-class ceiling $D_b(p) \le \frac{41}{64}\, bd^2 + \frac{5}{3}\, bd^{3/2}$ over every field by iterating the single-shift inclusion $\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}) \le H_{\{0,s\}}$ along doubled shift sets $E_0 = \{0\}, E_j = E_{j-1} \cup (E_{j-1} + t_j)$ ([8, Theorem 3.2]), and Theorem 3.5 of [8] proved $D_b(p) \le (1 - 1/(4\lceil\sqrt{2M}\,\rceil))bd^2$ for $M \le d/2$, which improves on the flag bound $(1-\frac{1}{2M})bd^2+O(bd)$ ([3, Theorem 5.1, Corollary 5.9(b), Remark 5.10, and Problem 9.1(a)]; coordinate form of Theorem 5.1 Lean-verified, Corollary 5.9(b) and Remark 5.10 proved in text) when $M \ge 11$. (Conversely, while the leading coefficient c_M of Theorem 5.5 below has a $\Theta(1/M)$ deficit that beats $1 - \frac{1}{2M}$ for all $M \ge 2$ and is smaller than $1 - 1/(4\lceil\sqrt{2M}\,\rceil)$ for $2 \le M \le 49$ and $51 \le M \le 54$—so Theorem 5.4 at $M = 2$ (for $d \ge 29$ with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$ against [8, Theorem 3.5], while improving on [8, Theorem 3.4] for all $d \ge 1$ with $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid d$) and Theorem 5.5(b) for $M \ge 3$ (at sufficiently large primes $d \ne \mathrm{char}(F)$) improve on [8, Theorem 3.5] once d exceeds the subleading crossover—the $\Theta(M^{-1/2})$ leading coefficient of [8, Theorem 3.5] is strictly smaller at $M = 50$ and for all $M \ge 55$, carries no $+bMd$ error term, and applies to composite $d \ge 2M$ and arbitrary characteristic.) At the same time, Theorem C.6 of [8] proved that this nested-component translate certificate method cannot go below $(\frac{5}{8} - o(1))bd^2$ ($\frac{5}{8} = \frac{40}{64} = 0.625$) on almost every two-class partition (and its full-ambient isolation variant cannot go below $(\frac{9}{16} - o(1))bd^2$, [8, Theorem C.7]). The structural reason for that ceiling is that $C \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(C) \le H_{\{0,s\}}$ uses only equality of decoder outputs across monochromatic edges $p(c) = p(c + s)$, a property shared by *arbitrary nonlinear deterministic decoders* $f_m : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to (F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ (`SharedDecoders.IsSharedCode`).

When the class decoders $\mathcal{A}_m : \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F^b) \to (F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ are F-*linear* ([3, Definition 6.3]), the single-shift intersection $U := \mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X})$ satisfies strictly more linear constraints than $H_{\{0,s\}}$. Fix $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ (identified with its canonical representative in $\{0, \dots, d-1\}$), let $g_s := \gcd(d, s)$ (`shiftGcd`) and $n := d/g_s$ (`shiftOrbitLen`), and partition $\mathbb{Z}_d$ into the g_s cyclic orbits O_a ($a \in \mathrm{Fin}\, g_s$, `shiftOrbit`) of $c \mapsto c + s$, each of length n. Along O_a, consider any maximal contiguous monochromatic run $I_r = \{c_r, c_r + s, \dots, c_r + (\ell_r - 1)s\} \subseteq J_m \cap O_a$ of class m, where $J_m = p^{-1}(m)$:

- Since $U \le H_{\{0,s\}}$, all ℓ_r matrices $\mathrm{rot}_{c_r+ts}(X)$ ($0 \le t \le \ell_r - 1$) have shifted rows $X_{c_r+ts,\cdot} = \mathrm{rot}_s^t(x_r^{(a)})$ determined by the single vector $x_r^{(a)} := X_{c_r,\cdot} \in (F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$ (writing $(\mathrm{rot}_s\, v)_j := v_{j+s}$ on $(F^b)^{\mathbb{Z}_d}$), and $X \in \mathcal{X}$ gives $\mathcal{A}_m(\mathrm{rot}_{c_r+ts}(X)) = \mathrm{rot}_s^t(x_r^{(a)})$ for $0 \le t \le \ell_r - 1$.

- Because $\mathrm{rot}_s(X)$ *also* lies in $\mathcal{X}$ and the right endpoint $c_r + (\ell_r - 1)s$ still belongs to J_m, evaluating the class-m rule for $\mathrm{rot}_s(X)$ at output column (row index) $c_r + (\ell_r - 1)s$ yields *one additional linear equation* at $t = \ell_r$:

$$\mathcal{A}_m(\mathrm{rot}_{c_r+\ell_r s}(X)) \;=\; \mathcal{A}_m(\mathrm{rot}_{c_r+(\ell_r-1)s}(\mathrm{rot}_s(X))) \;=\; \mathrm{rot}_s(X)_{c_r+(\ell_r-1)s,\cdot} \;=\; \mathrm{rot}_s^{\ell_r}(x_r^{(a)}),$$

  even though $c_r + \ell_r s \notin J_m$. Thus $\mathcal{A}_m$ is pinned down at $\ell_r + 1$ points along I_r rather than ℓ_r.

When $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid n$, passing to $\overline{F}$ with a primitive n-th root of unity ω_n (Proposition 2.1(b)–(c)) expands $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ in rot_s-eigenmodes and turns those run-extended equations into root-vanishing conditions on polynomials of bounded degree:

Lemma 5.1 (Polynomial root-vanishing bound)**.** Lean: `finrank_vanishCoeffs_le` [`ExtensionLinearRunSingleShift.lean`]

Let K be any field, let $D \in \mathbb{N}$, and let $S \subseteq K$ be a finite subset. The subspace `vanishCoeffs` $(K, D, S) \le K^{\mathrm{Fin}\, D}$ *of coefficient tuples $(c_0, \dots, c_{D-1})$ satisfying $\sum_{j=0}^{D-1} c_j z^j = 0$ for all $z \in S$ has dimension at most $D - |S|$ (with truncated subtraction in $\mathbb{N}$, hence 0 whenever $|S| \ge D$).*

Outline of the formal proof. Induct on D. At $D = 0$ the ambient space $K^{\mathrm{Fin}\, 0}$ is zero-dimensional. For $D + 1$ and nonempty S, choose $z_0 \in S$; every polynomial $P(Z)$ of degree $\le D$ vanishing at z_0 factors uniquely as $(Z - z_0)Q(Z)$ via a K-linear quotient map on coefficient tuples, injectively mapping `vanishCoeffs`$(K, D + 1, S)$ into `vanishCoeffs`$(K, D, S \setminus \{z_0\})$. □

For each orbit $a \in \mathrm{Fin}\, g_s$ and class $m \in \mathrm{Fin}\, M$, denote the orbit class size and right-endpoint run count (`orbitClassCard`, `orbitRunCount`) by

$$d_{m,a} \;:=\; |J_m \cap O_a|, \qquad T_{m,a} \;:=\; |\{c \in J_m \cap O_a \;:\; c + s \notin J_m\}|.$$

Write the single-shift quadratic bound (`theorem1ASingleShiftBound`) as

$$B_{\mathrm{run}}(b, p, s) \;:=\; b g_s \sum_{a=0}^{g_s - 1} \sum_{m=0}^{M-1} \Big(T_{m,a}(n - d_{m,a}) \;-\; \tfrac{1}{2} T_{m,a}^2 \;+\; \tfrac{1}{2} T_{m,a} \Big) \;+\; b g_s d.$$

Theorem 5.2 (Single-shift run-extension bound for linear shared decoders)**.** Lean: `extension_Theorem1A_SingleShift`, `linearClassUniform_singleShift_finrank_le` [`ExtensionLinearRunSingleShift.lean`]

Let F be a field, let $d, M, b \ge 1$, let $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M$, and let $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ with $g_s = \gcd(d, s)$ and $n = d/g_s$.

(a) For every $a \in \mathrm{Fin}\, g_s$ and $m \in \mathrm{Fin}\, M$, $T_{m,a} \le n - d_{m,a}$.

(b) Whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid n$ (`CoprimeToChar` *F n), every subspace $\mathcal{X} \le \mathrm{Mat}_{d \times d}(F^b)$ satisfying* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$ obeys*

$$\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \;\le\; B_{\mathrm{run}}(b, p, s).$$

Outline of the formal proof. Part (a) holds because the map $c \mapsto c + s$ injects $\{c \in J_m \cap O_a : c + s \notin J_m\}$ into $O_a \setminus J_m$. For (b), extend scalars to $K = \overline{F}$ via Proposition 2.1(b)–(c) and pick a primitive n-th root of unity $\omega \in K^\times$. Decompose K-matrices into rot_s-eigenmodes $E_\eta = \{Y : \mathrm{rot}_s(Y) = \omega^\eta Y\}$ $(0 \le \eta < n)$ via `fourierCoeffs` and `modeLift`, and apply `LeanMachine.SequentialDimension.finrank_le_sum_of_prefix` in descending degree order $D = n - 1 - k$ $(0 \le k < n)$. When modes $> D$ of $X \in \mathcal{X}_K \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}_K)$ vanish, on each row-orbit O_a, class m, and column-orbit $a' \in \mathrm{Fin}\, g_s$, evaluating $\mathcal{A}_{m,K}$ on both X and $\mathrm{rot}_s(X)$ expresses the mode-D coefficients along $c = a_0 + ts \in J_m \cap O_a$ via a (K^b)-valued polynomial $P(Z) = \sum_{\eta=0}^{D} v_\eta Z^\eta$ obeying both $P(\omega^t) = \alpha_D(a_0 + ts, a')$ and $P(\omega^{t+1}) = \omega^D \alpha_D(a_0 + ts, a')$. Hence the twisted values $\omega^{-tD} P(\omega^t)$ are constant across all $\ell_r + 1$ points $t_r, \dots, t_r + \ell_r$ of each run of $J_m \cap O_a$, and $P(\omega Z) - \omega^D P(Z) = \sum_{\eta=0}^{D-1} (\omega^\eta - \omega^D) v_\eta Z^\eta$ vanishes at all $d_{m,a}$ roots ω^t $(a_0 + ts \in J_m \cap O_a)$. Since $\omega^\eta \ne \omega^D$ for $\eta < D$, Lemma 5.1 bounds each (a, m, a') block at step D by $b \cdot$ `stepRunBound`$(d_{m,a}, T_{m,a}, D)$, where `stepRunBound` equals 0 if $d_{m,a} = 0$, 1 if $d_{m,a} = n$ ($T_{m,a} = 0$, summing over $0 \le D < n$ to $n = d_{m,a}$), and $\min(T_{m,a},\, 1 + \max(0, D - d_{m,a}))$

when $1 \le d_{m,a} < n$ ($T_{m,a} \ge 1$). In the latter case, using $T_{m,a} \le n - d_{m,a}$, the $d_{m,a}$ steps $0 \le D < d_{m,a}$ contribute 1 each ($+d_{m,a}$) and the remaining steps $d_{m,a} \le D < n$ contribute $\sum_{u=0}^{n-d_{m,a}-1} \min(T_{m,a}, 1+u) = T_{m,a}(n - d_{m,a} - T_{m,a}) + \binom{T_{m,a}+1}{2} = T_{m,a}(n-d_{m,a}) - \frac{1}{2}T_{m,a}^2 + \frac{1}{2}T_{m,a}$. Summing over $a' \in \operatorname{Fin} g_s$, $a \in \operatorname{Fin} g_s$, and $m \in \operatorname{Fin} M$ with $\sum_{a,m} d_{m,a} = d$ gives $B_{\mathrm{run}}(b,p,s)$. □

Unlike $H_{\{0,1\}}$, which has full dimension d^2 whenever no two adjacent columns share a class, Theorem 5.2 cuts the single-shift intersection down to $\frac{1}{4}d^2 + \frac{3}{2}d$ on the alternating two-coloring, and this bound is attained with equality over *every* field:

Theorem 5.3 (All-field sharpness of Theorem 5.2 on the alternating coloring)**.** Lean: `extension_Theorem1A_AlternatingSharpness`, `alternatingSharpCode_finrank_and_shift_inf` [`ExtensionLinearRunSharpness.lean`]

Let F be any *field (of arbitrary characteristic) and let $m \ge 1$ and $d = 2m$. For the alternating two-coloring $p(c) = c \bmod 2$ (`altTwoColoring`, for $c \in \{0, \dots, 2m-1\}$) at $b = 1$ and shift $s = 1$:*

(a) With $g_1 = 1$, $n = 2m$, $d_{0,0} = d_{1,0} = m$, and $T_{0,0} = T_{1,0} = m$, the nonlinear covariance space $H_{\{0,1\}}$ has $\dim_F H_{\{0,1\}} = (2m)^2 = d^2$, and $B_{\mathrm{run}}(1,p,1) = m^2 + 3m = \frac{1}{4}d^2 + \frac{3}{2}d$.

(b) The explicit position-space symmetric decoder pair `alternatingSharpDecoder` defines a linear class-uniform code $\mathcal{X} :=$ `alternatingSharpCode`(F,m) (`SwapRigidity.IsClassUniformCode`) satisfying

$$\dim_F \mathcal{X} \;=\; 2m(m+1) \;=\; \frac{1}{2}d^2 + d, \qquad \dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \;=\; m^2 + 3m \;=\; \frac{1}{4}d^2 + \frac{3}{2}d,$$

matching $B_{\mathrm{run}}(1,p,1)$ over every field F—hence attaining Theorem 5.2(b) with equality whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \nmid 2m$, and showing even when $\mathrm{char}(F) \mid 2m$ (including characteristic 2 for every $m \ge 1$) that $m^2 + 3m$ cannot be lowered.

Outline of the formal proof. Because $p(c) \ne p(c+1)$ for all $c \in \mathbb{Z}_{2m}$, the implication in $H_{\{0,1\}}$ is vacuous, giving $\dim_F H_{\{0,1\}} = (2m)^2$. Decomposing $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{2m\times 2m}(F)$ into four $m \times m$ parity blocks $(B_{i,j}, A_{i,j}, C_{i,j}, D_{i,j}) = (X_{2i,2j}, X_{2i,2j+1}, X_{2i+1,2j}, X_{2i+1,2j+1})$ $(i,j \in \mathbb{Z}_m)$, `alternatingSharpDecoder` reads only even rows at class 0 and only odd rows at class 1, so $X \in \mathcal{X}$ if and only if B and C are symmetric ($M_{i,j} = M_{j,i}$) while A and D are shifted-symmetric ($M_{i,j} = M_{j+1,i-1}$). Over every field F, each of the four blocks is parameterized by unordered pairs in $\mathrm{Sym}^2(\mathbb{Z}_m)$ of dimension $\frac{m(m+1)}{2}$, giving $\dim_F \mathcal{X} = 4 \cdot \frac{m(m+1)}{2} = 2m(m+1)$. Intersecting with $\mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})$ keeps B and C symmetric ($\frac{m(m+1)}{2}$ each) and forces A and D to be both symmetric and shifted-symmetric, hence constant along cyclic anti-diagonals $i + j \in \mathbb{Z}_m$ (dimension m each), leaving exact dimension $2 \cdot \frac{m(m+1)}{2} + 2m = m^2 + 3m$. □

5.2 Universal 19/32 two-class ceiling and prime-d multi-class bounds

Averaging Theorem 5.2 across shifts $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ via the Grassmann identity $2\dim_F \mathcal{X} \le bd^2 + \dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}))$ yields universal dimension bounds that improve strictly on the $\frac{5}{8}$ nested-component certificate floor of [8, Theorem C.6] for two classes and beat the flag bound $(1 - \frac{1}{2M})bd^2$ for every $M \ge 2$ (for all d coprime to $\mathrm{char}(F)$ at $M = 2$, and at prime $d \ne \mathrm{char}(F)$ for $M \ge 3$):

Theorem 5.4 (Universal 19/32 capacity ceiling for two-class linear shared decoders)**.** Lean: `extension_Theorem1B_TwoClass`, `linearClassUniform_twoClass_finrank_le` [`ExtensionLinearRunProofs.lean`]

Let F be a field and let $d, b \geq 1$. For any finite set κ, any $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$, and any $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$, write $Q_s := |\{c \in \mathbb{Z}_d : p(c) \neq p(c+s)\}|$ (`shiftTransitionCount`).

(a) Per-shift orbit-aggregated bound*: for every $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} 2$ and every $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ with $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid (d/g_s)$, every $\mathcal{X}$ satisfying* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$ obeys*

$$\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \operatorname{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \;\leq\; b\Big(\frac{1}{2}\,Q_s d \;-\; \frac{1}{4}\,Q_s^2 \;+\; \frac{1}{2}\,g_s Q_s \;+\; g_s d\Big).$$

(b) Universal two-class bound*: whenever $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid d$, for every finite set κ with $|\kappa| \leq 2$ and every $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$, every $\mathcal{X}$ satisfying* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$—and hence $D_b(p) =$* `lineарClassUniformMaxDim`*(F, b, p)—satisfies*

$$\dim_F \mathcal{X} \;\leq\; \frac{19}{32}\,bd^2 \;+\; \frac{3}{2}\,bd^{3/2}.$$

Here $\frac{19}{32} = \frac{38}{64} = 0.59375 < \frac{5}{8} = \frac{40}{64} < \frac{41}{64}$, strictly below both the $\frac{41}{64}$ bound of [8, Theorem 3.4] and the $\frac{5}{8}$ nested-component certificate floor of [8, Theorem C.6].

Outline of the formal proof. Re-index κ into $\operatorname{Fin} 2$. On each orbit O_a of $c \mapsto c+s$, a two-coloring has equal transition counts $T_{0,a} = T_{1,a} =: t_a$ with $(n - d_{0,a}) + (n - d_{1,a}) = n$ and $2\sum_{a=0}^{g_s-1} t_a = Q_s$. Thus Theorem 5.2(b) gives $B_{\mathrm{run}}(b, p, s) = bg_s \sum_a (t_a n - t_a^2 + t_a) + bg_s d$, and Cauchy–Schwarz across the g_s orbits ($g_s \sum_a t_a^2 \geq (Q_s/2)^2$) cancels g_s in the quadratic term to prove (a). For (b), since $n_s = d/g_s \mid d$, $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid d$ implies $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid n_s$ for all $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$. Averaging $2\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq bd^2 + \dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \operatorname{rot}_s^{-1}(\mathcal{X}))$ uniformly over all d shifts $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ uses $\frac{1}{d}\sum_s Q_s = 2\alpha(1-\alpha)d \leq d/2$ (where αd is a class size), $\frac{1}{d}\sum_s Q_s^2 \geq \big(\frac{1}{d}\sum_s Q_s\big)^2$ by Cauchy–Schwarz, $\max_{q \in [0,1/2]}\big(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}q - \frac{1}{8}q^2\big) = \frac{19}{32}$ at $q = \frac{1}{2}$, $Q_s \leq d$, and divisor counting $\sum_{s \in \mathbb{Z}_d} g_s = \sum_{g \mid d} g\,\varphi(d/g) \leq d \cdot \#\{g : g \mid d\} \leq 2d^{3/2}$, so the subleading term $\frac{1}{2}b\big(\frac{1}{2}g_s Q_s + g_s d\big) \leq \frac{3}{4}bg_s d$ averages over $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ to at most $\frac{3}{4}b \cdot 2d^{3/2} = \frac{3}{2}bd^{3/2}$. □

Theorem 5.5 (Multi-class linear capacity ceiling at prime dimensions)**.** Lean: `extension_Theorem1B_MultiClassPrime`, `multiClass_simplex_max_iff`, `linearClassUniform_multiClass_prime_finrank_le`, `linearClassUniform_multiClass_prime_maxDim_le` [`ExtensionLinearRunProofs.lean`]

For $M \geq 2$, define the rational leading coefficient (`multiClassLeadingCoeff`*)*

$$c_M \;:=\; 1 \;-\; \frac{5}{4M} \;+\; \frac{1}{M^2} \;-\; \frac{1}{4M^3}.$$

(a) Unique simplex maximum*: for every $M \geq 2$ and every probability vector $\alpha : \operatorname{Fin} M \to \mathbb{R}$ ($\alpha_m \geq 0$, $\sum_{m=0}^{M-1} \alpha_m = 1$),*

$$\frac{1}{2} \;+\; \frac{1}{2}\sum_{m=0}^{M-1} \alpha_m(1-\alpha_m)^2\Big(1 - \frac{\alpha_m}{2}\Big) \;\leq\; c_M,$$

with equality if and only if $\alpha_m = 1/M$ for all $m \in \operatorname{Fin} M$.

(b) Prime-d bound*: for every prime d, every field F with $\operatorname{char}(F) \neq d$, every $M \geq 3$, every $b \geq 1$, and every $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M$, every subspace $\mathcal{X}$ satisfying* `IsLinearClassUniformCode` *p $\mathcal{X}$—and hence $D_b(p)$—obeys*

$$\dim_F \mathcal{X} \;\leq\; c_M\,bd^2 \;+\; bMd.$$

(c) Strict win over the flag bound for all $M \geq 2$*: for every* $M \geq 2$*,*

$$c_M \;<\; 1 - \frac{1}{2M} \qquad \left(\textit{difference } \frac{(M-1)(3M-1)}{4M^3} > 0\right);$$

in particular $c_3 = \frac{37}{54} \approx 0.6852 < \frac{5}{6}$ *and* $c_4 = \frac{191}{256} \approx 0.7461 < \frac{7}{8}$.

Outline of the formal proof. For (a), let $f(x) := x(1-x)^2(1-x/2)$. When $M = 2$, $\alpha_1 = 1 - \alpha_0$ and the explicit sum-of-squares identity $2f(1/2) - (f(x) + f(1-x)) = (x - 1/2)^2(\frac{1}{2} + (x-1/2)^2) \geq 0$ vanishes if and only if $x = 1/2$. When $M \geq 3$, set $c := 1/M \leq 1/3$; for every $x \in [0,1]$, the global tangent-line sum-of-squares identity

$$f(c) + f'(c)(x-c) - f(x) \;=\; (x-c)^2\Big(\tfrac{1}{2}(1-x)(3-x-2c) + \tfrac{3}{2}\big(\tfrac{1}{3}-c\big)^2 + 2\big(\tfrac{1}{3}-c\big) + \tfrac{1}{6}\Big) \;\geq\; \tfrac{1}{6}(x-c)^2$$

sums over $m \in \operatorname{Fin} M$ using $\sum_m (\alpha_m - c) = 0$ to give $\sum_m f(\alpha_m) \leq M f(1/M)$, with equality if and only if every $\alpha_m = 1/M$. For (b), when d is prime, every $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d \setminus \{0\}$ has $g_s = 1$ and $n_s = d$; writing $d_m := |J_m|$, summing Theorem 5.2(b) over $s \neq 0$ (with $T_{m,0}(0) = 0$) uses $\sum_{s \neq 0} T_{m,0}(s) = d_m(d - d_m)$, Cauchy–Schwarz over all d shifts $d \sum_{s \neq 0} T_{m,0}(s)^2 \geq d_m^2 (d - d_m)^2$, and (a) at $\alpha_m = d_m/d$, leaving a linear error term $\frac{5}{4} bd \leq bMd$ for $M \geq 3$. Part (c) is direct algebra. □

Remark 5.6 (Scope in positive characteristic dividing d, and remaining gap to $1/2$)**.** Because Theorem 5.2(b) relies on distinct n-th roots of unity in $\overline{F}$, Theorem 5.4(b) requires $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid d$ and does not apply, for example, at $d = 2^m$ ($m \geq 2$) in characteristic 2 (where Mahler binomial polynomials $\binom{c}{j}$ mod 2 can vanish on more than j elements of $\mathbb{Z}_{2^m}$). Even when $\operatorname{char}(F) \nmid d$, the constant $\frac{19}{32} = 0.59375$ narrows the gap toward $\frac{1}{2} + o(1)$ in [3, Problem 9.1(a)] (and drops below the $\frac{5}{8} = 0.625$ nested-component floor of [8, Theorem C.6], while remaining above the $\frac{9}{16} = 0.5625$ full-ambient isolation floor of [8, Theorem C.7]), leaving $D_b(p) \leq (\frac{1}{2} + o(1))bd^2$ open.

6 Exact dimension 25 for the aperiodic partition of $\mathbb{Z}_6$

Problem 9.1(b) of [3] asks for the exact maximum scalar ($b = 1$) dimension $D_1(\{0,1,3\}, \{2,4,5\})$ (written D in [3]) of a linear class-uniform code on $\mathbb{Z}_6$ for the aperiodic two-class partition $J_0 = \{0,1,3\}$, $J_1 = \{2,4,5\}$ (`SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls`, the smallest partition of $\mathbb{Z}_d$ with no shift almost-period in which a code beats the interval value $(d^2 + Md)/2 = 24$). Prior to this work, the known bounds were $25 \leq D_1 \leq 28$ over every field in which $3 \neq 0$ (and $24 \leq D_1 \leq 28$ in characteristic 3): Theorem TP ([3, Theorem 6.4], Lean-verified) gives $D_1 \leq 28$ over every field, while a 25-dimensional code was constructed over $\mathbb{F}_2$ in [3, Proposition 8.2] (Lean-verified) and extended to every field with $3 \neq 0$ in [7, Theorem 3.2] (`ClassUniformMemo.exists_code_of_three_ne_zero`, Lean-verified, pushing forward the $\mathbb{F}_2$ certificate in characteristic 2 and supplying two integer echelon certificates for all characteristics outside $\{2,3\}$). Note that Theorem 5.2(b) alone at $d = 6, b = 1, s = 1$ ($d_{0,0} = d_{1,0} = 3$, $T_{0,0} = T_{1,0} = 2$) gives $\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \leq 2(2 \cdot 3 - \frac{1}{2} \cdot 4 + \frac{1}{2} \cdot 2) + 6 = 16$, yielding $2 \dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 36 + 16 = 52$, i.e. $\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 26$, still one dimension above 25.

By analyzing the coupled cross-mode constraints across all six column-Fourier modes of $H_{\{0,1\}}$ simultaneously, we sharpen the single-shift intersection bound to 14 and establish $D_1(\{0,1,3\}, \{2,4,5\}) = 25$ in [3, Problem 9.1(b)] over every field of characteristic outside $\{2,3\}$.

Lemma 6.1 (Single-shift intersection bound 14 for $\{0,1,3\} \mid \{2,4,5\}$ on $\mathbb{Z}_6$)**.** Lean: `extension_Theorem2_Preliminaries`, `aperiodicSix_shift_inf_finrank_le_14` [`ExtensionAperiodicSixProofs.lean`]

Let F be a field.

(a) The Boolean partition `SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls` $: \mathbb{Z}_6 \to \mathrm{Bool}$ *has* ***`true`****-fiber* $\{0,1,3\}$ *and* ***`false`****-fiber* $\{2,4,5\}$*, and for every field F the three conditions* $(\mathrm{char}(F) \neq 2 \wedge \mathrm{char}(F) \neq 3)$*,* $((2:F) \neq 0 \wedge (3:F) \neq 0)$*, and* `CoprimeToChar`$(F,6)$ *are equivalent.*

(b) Whenever $\mathrm{char}(F) \notin \{2,3\}$*, every subspace* $\mathcal{X} \leq \mathrm{Mat}_{6\times 6}(F)$ *satisfying* `SwapRigidity.IsClassUniformCode SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls` $\mathcal{X}$ *obeys*

$$\dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) \;\leq\; 14.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Part (a) is direct verification on $\mathbb{Z}_6$ and prime factors of 6. For (b), extend scalars to $K = \overline{F}$ via Proposition 2.1(b)–(c) and choose a primitive 6-th root of unity $\zeta \in K^\times$ ($\zeta^2 = \zeta - 1$, with $(2:K) \neq 0$ and $(3:K) \neq 0$). Because $W := \mathcal{X}_K \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X}_K)$ lies in $H_{\{0,1\}}$ ($X_{1,j} = X_{0,j+1}$ and $X_{5,j} = X_{4,j+1}$), $H_{\{0,1\}}$ has dimension $4 \cdot 6 = 24$ and decomposes into six 4-dimensional column-Fourier eigenspaces $V_\eta = \{Y \in H_{\{0,1\}} : \mathrm{rot}_1(Y) = \zeta^\eta Y\}$ ($\eta \in \mathbb{Z}_6$). Let $K_\eta := W \cap V_\eta$, $W_{\mathrm{pure}} := \bigoplus_{\eta\in\mathbb{Z}_6} K_\eta$, $S_K := \sum_{\eta\in\mathbb{Z}_6} \dim_K K_\eta$, and $Q := W/W_{\mathrm{pure}}$, so $\dim_K W = S_K + \dim_K Q$.

1. *Pure-mode cap $S_K \leq 12$:* on a single mode $Y \in V_\eta$, $\mathrm{rot}_c(Y) = \zeta^{c\eta} Y$, so the linear decoder $\mathcal{A}_{m,K}$ outputs $\zeta^{c\eta}\mathcal{A}_{m,K}(Y)$ across every $c \in J_m$ ($m \in \{0,1\}$), forcing Y to be class-shift covariant on all of J_0 and all of J_1; this cuts each K_η down to a 2-dimensional subspace $L_\eta \leq V_\eta$ and gives $\dim_K K_\eta \leq 2$ for every $\eta \in \mathbb{Z}_6$, hence $S_K \leq 12$.

2. *Antipodal quotient inequality* $3\dim_K Q + S_K \leq 24$: for each $a \in \{0,1,2\}$, let $S_a := \mathbb{Z}_6 \setminus \{a, a+3\}$ and $W_{S_a} := W \cap \bigoplus_{\eta\in S_a} V_\eta$. Because both classes have size 3 with antipodal cancellation and $(Z^6-1)/(Z-\zeta^{c_0})$ has all six coefficients nonzero, any $Y \in W_{S_a}$ has each of its four mode components $\pi_\eta(Y)$ ($\eta \in S_a$) individually in W, i.e. $W_{S_a} = \bigoplus_{\eta\in S_a} K_\eta$. Thus the induced map $Q \to (V_a/K_a) \oplus (V_{a+3}/K_{a+3})$ is injective for each $a \in \{0,1,2\}$. Summing $\dim_K Q \leq 8 - \dim_K K_a - \dim_K K_{a+3}$ over $a \in \{0,1,2\}$ yields $3\dim_K Q + S_K \leq 24$. Whenever $S_K \leq 10$, this immediately gives $\dim_K W = S_K + \dim_K Q \leq S_K + \lfloor (24 - S_K)/3 \rfloor \leq 14$.

3. *Closing $S_K = 11$ and $S_K = 12$:* using the exact anti-diagonal zeros of the $\mathbb{Z}_6$ DFT interpolation matrices at shift $\eta + 3 \leftrightarrow \eta$ to eliminate the single unconstrained column ($c = 5$ for J_0, $c = 1$ for J_1), pairwise disjointness of the antipodal projection kernels eliminates $S_K = 11, \dim_K Q \geq 4$ (where a $2+2$ kernel decomposition forces two coupled blocks to vanish and forces two kernels to coincide) and reduces $S_K = 12, \dim_K Q \geq 3$ to a parameter-free 4×4 linear system over $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta, \frac{1}{6}]$ (determinant $\frac{16}{3}$, or $3^4 \cdot \frac{16}{3} = 432 = 2^4 \cdot 3^3$ with entries $\pm 3, \pm(2\zeta - 1)$ after clearing thirds) proved nonsingular by direct row elimination using $(2:K) \neq 0$, $(3:K) \neq 0$, and $(2\zeta-1)^2 = -3 \neq 0$. Hence $\dim_K W \leq 14$ in all cases.

□

Theorem 6.2 (Exact dimension 25 for $\{0,1,3\} \mid \{2,4,5\}$ outside characteristics 2 and 3)**.** Lean: `aperiodicSix_finrank_le_25`, `aperiodicSix_maxDim_eq_25`, `extension_Theorem2_AperiodicSixExact` [`ExtensionAperiodicSixProofs.lean`]

Let F be any field with $\mathrm{char}(F) \neq 2$ *and* $\mathrm{char}(F) \neq 3$.

(a) Every subspace $\mathcal{X} \leq \mathrm{Mat}_{6\times 6}(F)$ satisfying `SwapRigidity.IsClassUniformCode SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls` $\mathcal{X}$ *obeys* $2\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 36 + 14 = 50$ *and hence* $\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 25$.

(b) Combining (a) with [7, Theorem 3.2] (`ClassUniformMemo.exists_code_of_three_ne_zero`*), the set of achievable dimensions $\{\dim_F \mathcal{X}\}$ over all $\mathcal{X}$ satisfying* `SwapRigidity.IsClassUniformCode SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls` $\mathcal{X}$ *has greatest element* 25*, and*

$$D_1(\{0,1,3\},\, \{2,4,5\}) \;=\; 25$$

(formalized as `linearClassUniformMaxDim`$(F, 1, \mathrm{cls}) = 25$ *at* cls $=$ `SwapRigidity.aperiodicCls`*). The same bounds and exact maximum* 25 *hold for every coloring* $\mathrm{cls} : \mathbb{Z}_6 \to \kappa$ *with fibers* $\{0,1,3\}$ *and* $\{2,4,5\}$ *(*`IsAperiodicSixPartition`*).*

Outline of the formal proof. Since rot_1 is an F-linear automorphism of $\mathrm{Mat}_{6\times 6}(F)$ of ambient dimension 36, Grassmann's formula $\dim_F(\mathcal{X} + \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) + \dim_F(\mathcal{X} \cap \mathrm{rot}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{X})) = 2\dim_F \mathcal{X}$ together with Lemma 6.1(b) yields $2\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 36 + 14 = 50$, so $\dim_F \mathcal{X} \leq 25$. Since $\mathrm{char}(F) \neq 3$ implies $(3 : F) \neq 0$, `ClassUniformMemo.exists_code_of_three_ne_zero` supplies a 25-dimensional code over F, proving `IsGreatest` and `linearClassUniformMaxDim` $= 25$; re-indexing the two fibers transfers the result to any cls satisfying `IsAperiodicSixPartition`. □

Remark 6.3 (Remaining characteristics 2 and 3)**.** Over $\mathrm{char}(F) = 2$ ($25 \leq D_1 \leq 28$, [3, Proposition 8.2]) and $\mathrm{char}(F) = 3$ ($24 \leq D_1 \leq 28$, [7, Problem 6.1]), $Z^6 - 1$ factors with repeated roots as $(Z^3 - 1)^2$ and $(Z^2 - 1)^3$, so $\mathbb{Z}_6$ is not semisimple over $\overline{F}$ and both characteristics remain open.

7 Three-term swap codes and one- and two-sided interval-mask bounds

7.1 Three-term swap codes exceeding $d(d+1)/2$ at $d \in \{6,7,9,12\}$ and over all fields at $d = 4$

For finite matrix families $A, B : \alpha \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ over a field F, the swap code (`SwapRigidity.swapCode`) is the solution space

$$\texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A,B) \;:=\; \Big\{X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F) \;:\; \sum_{a\in\alpha} A_a X B_a^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}\Big\}.$$

In [3, Theorem 5.1 and Corollary 5.5] (where the coordinate form of Theorem 5.1 is Lean-verified and Corollary 5.5 is proved in text), any two-term swap code ($|\alpha| = 2$) has dimension at most the symmetric pairing value $d(d+1)/2$, proved by triangularizing a matrix pencil over an algebraic closure. Immediately afterward, Remark 5.6 of [3] noted that three terms can exceed $d(d+1)/2$, giving an explicit three-term family of dimension $8 > 6$ at $d = 3$ over every field and an example of dimension $11 > 10$ at $d = 4$ (checked numerically there over $\mathbb{F}_2, \mathbb{F}_3, \mathbb{F}_5, \mathbb{F}_7$), and remarked: *"We have no three-term example for $d \geq 5$."*

Here we give explicit three-term examples above $d(d+1)/2$ at $d \in \{6,7,9,12\}$ over every field F, together with a uniform proof over every field at $d = 4$, by lifting the 3×3 skew-pair

construction into $m \times m$ blocks (`threeTermBlockA`, `threeTermBlockB`) and adjoining a diagonal tail (`threeTermPaddedA`, `threeTermPaddedB`). Write the three off-diagonal pairs of $\{0,1,2\}$ as $(i_0, j_0) = (0,1)$, $(i_1, j_1) = (0,2)$, and $(i_2, j_2) = (1,2)$, and set

$$A_t \;:=\; (E_{i_t,j_t} - E_{j_t,i_t}) \otimes I_m, \qquad B_t \;:=\; -A_t \;=\; (E_{j_t,i_t} - E_{i_t,j_t}) \otimes I_m \qquad (t \in \{0,1,2\}).$$

Because $E_{j_t,i_t}^{\mathsf{T}} - E_{i_t,j_t}^{\mathsf{T}} = E_{i_t,j_t} - E_{j_t,i_t}$, we have $B_t^{\mathsf{T}} = A_t$, so the swap-code equation $\sum_{t=0}^{2} A_t X B_t^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ is

$$\sum_{t=0}^{2} ((E_{i_t,j_t} - E_{j_t,i_t}) \otimes I_m)\, X\, ((E_{i_t,j_t} - E_{j_t,i_t}) \otimes I_m) \;=\; X^{\mathsf{T}}.$$

Theorem 7.1 (Dimension $4m(m+1)$ of the three-term block family on $d = 3m$)**.** Lean: `bonus1_ThreeTermBlockSwapCodeDim` [`SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean`]

Let F be any field and let $m \geq 1$. Partition $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{3m\times 3m}(F)$ into a 3×3 grid of $m \times m$ blocks $(X_{i,j})_{0\leq i,j<3}$.

(a) X lies in `SwapRigidity.swapCode`$(A,B) = \{X : \sum_{t=0}^{2} A_t X B_t^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}\}$ *if and only if every block $X_{i,j}$ is symmetric ($X_{i,j}^{\mathsf{T}} = X_{i,j}$ for all $0 \leq i,j < 3$) and the three diagonal blocks sum to zero ($X_{0,0} + X_{1,1} + X_{2,2} = 0$;* `IsThreeByThreeSymmetricZeroTraceBlocks`*).*

(b) Consequently, over every field F,

$$\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A,B) \;=\; 8 \cdot \frac{m(m+1)}{2} \;=\; 4m(m+1).$$

Since $4m(m+1) - \frac{3m(3m+1)}{2} = \frac{m(5-m)}{2}$, this exceeds the pairing value $d(d+1)/2$ ($d = 3m$) for $m \in \{1,2,3,4\}$ ($d = 3 : 8 > 6$, matching [3, Remark 5.6]; $d = 6 : 24 > 21$; $d = 9 : 48 > 45$; and $d = 12 : 80 > 78$).

Outline of the formal proof. For each $t \in \{0,1,2\}$, multiplying on both sides by $(E_{i_t,j_t} - E_{j_t,i_t}) \otimes I_m$ places $+X_{j_t,i_t}$ in block (i_t, j_t), $+X_{i_t,j_t}$ in block (j_t, i_t), $-X_{j_t,j_t}$ in block (i_t, i_t), and $-X_{i_t,i_t}$ in block (j_t, j_t). Summing over the three pairs sends each off-diagonal block (i,j) $(i \neq j)$ to $+X_{j,i}$ and each diagonal block (i,i) to $-\sum_{j\neq i} X_{j,j}$. Equating with $(X_{j,i}^{\mathsf{T}})_{i,j}$ gives $X_{j,i} = X_{j,i}^{\mathsf{T}}$ for $i \neq j$ together with $-X_{1,1} - X_{2,2} = X_{0,0}^{\mathsf{T}}$, $-X_{0,0} - X_{2,2} = X_{1,1}^{\mathsf{T}}$, and $-X_{0,0} - X_{1,1} = X_{2,2}^{\mathsf{T}}$. Over every ring (including characteristic 2), subtracting pairs of diagonal equations yields $X_{0,0}^{\mathsf{T}} - X_{1,1}^{\mathsf{T}} = X_{1,1} - X_{0,0}$ and cyclic analogues, which together with $X_{2,2} = -X_{0,0}^{\mathsf{T}} - X_{1,1}$ is equivalent to $X_{i,i}^{\mathsf{T}} = X_{i,i}$ for $i \in \{0,1,2\}$ and $X_{0,0} + X_{1,1} + X_{2,2} = 0$. Eight independent symmetric $m \times m$ blocks (6 off-diagonal and 2 free diagonal blocks) each have dimension $m(m+1)/2$, giving $4m(m+1)$. □

Embedding the $3m \times 3m$ family in the top-left corner of $\mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ ($d = 3m + s$) and setting both A_2 and B_2 equal to I_s on the trailing $s \times s$ diagonal block extends the construction to $d = 4$ and $d = 7$.

Theorem 7.2 (Padded three-term swap codes across $d \in \{3, 4, 6, 7, 9, 12\}$)**.** Lean: `bonus1_ThreeTermPaddedSevenAndFive` [`SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean`]
Lean: `bonus1_UnifiedThreeTermExceedsPairingBound` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]
Over every field F:

(a) Padding $m = 2$ ($3m = 6$) to $d = 7$ achieves dimension $29 > 28 = \frac{7\cdot 8}{2}$; padding $m = 1$ ($3m = 3$) to $d = 4$ achieves $11 > 10 = \frac{4\cdot 5}{2}$; and padding $m = 1$ to $d = 5$ achieves $15 = \frac{5\cdot 6}{2}$.

(b) Consequently, for every field F and every $d \in \{3, 4, 6, 7, 9, 12\}$, there exist $A, B : \mathrm{Fin}\, 3 \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ with

$$\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) \;>\; \frac{d(d+1)}{2}.$$

Outline of the formal proof. On the trailing $s = d - 3m$ coordinates, A_2 and B_2^{T} both act as $+I_s$, while A_0, B_0, A_1, B_1 vanish outside the top-left $3m \times 3m$ block. Inspecting the coupled cross-blocks between the active $(1, 2)$ pair and the s-coordinate tail yields $24+5 = 29$ dimensions at $(m, d) = (2, 7)$, $8 + 3 = 11$ at $(1, 4)$, and $8 + 7 = 15$ at $(1, 5)$. Combining $(1, 4)$ and $(2, 7)$ with $m \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ in Theorem 7.1 covers $d \in \{3, 4, 6, 7, 9, 12\}$. □

More generally, taking $m = \lfloor d/3 \rfloor$ and $s = d - 3m \in \{0, 1, 2\}$, at $d = 3m + s$ this block-and-tail construction achieves dimension $4m(m + 1) + \frac{s(s+1)}{2} + 2ms = \frac{d(d+1)}{2} + \frac{m(5-m-2s)}{2}$, which is at most $d(d+1)/2$ for every $(m \geq 1, s \geq 0)$ with $d \geq 5$ outside $\{6, 7, 9, 12\}$ (giving $15 = 15$ at $d = 5$, $35 < 36$ at $d = 8$, $55 = 55$ at $d = 10$, $63 < 66$ at $d = 11$, $120 = 120$ at $d = 15$, and strictly less than $d(d+1)/2$ once $m \geq 6$). Thus whether a three-term swap code can exceed $d(d + 1)/2$ remains open for $d = 5$ and for every $d \geq 8$ outside $\{9, 12\}$.

7.2 One-sided and two-sided bounds for multi-scale interval masks (Problem 9.3)

Problem 9.3 of [3] asks for upper bounds on $\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B)$ when $d = 2^m$ and both A_a and B_a lie in the span of dyadic masks across all scales composed with cyclic rotations ([3, Corollary 6.13], proved in text, covers one-sided tensor-factor rules commuting with a single non-derogatory matrix on one address digit). We first record the one-sided endpoint-refinement baseline, then prove a characteristic-free two-sided coarse–fine bound that improves strictly on it whenever both sides localize fine intervals to proper regions of $\mathbb{Z}_d$, and finally contrast interval masks with periodic Walsh digit masks.

For contiguous cyclic or aligned dyadic intervals (`IsCyclicInterval`, `IsAlignedDyadicInterval`; spans `InMultiscaleIntervalRotSpan`, `InAlignedDyadicIntervalRotSpan`), each interval mask introduces at most two boundary transitions around $\mathbb{Z}_d$, so applying Theorem TP ([3, Theorem 6.4], Lean-verified) to the common refinement of the interval endpoints on one side at a time gives a nontrivial upper bound whenever at least one side uses $o(d)$ intervals in total:

Proposition 7.3 (One-sided endpoint-refinement bound for multi-scale interval masks)**.** Lean: `bonus2_MultiscaleIntervalBothSides`, `bonus2_MultiscaleFullProfileAttainsFullSwap` [`SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean`]
Lean: `bonus2_SublinearProfileAndTendstoHalf`, `bonus2_SublinearProfileExplicitThreshold` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]
Let F be any field, $m \geq 0$, and $d = 2^m$.

(a) Every `InAlignedDyadicIntervalRotSpan` *family lies in* `InMultiscaleIntervalRotSpan`*, and whenever finite families $A, B : \alpha \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ lie in* `InMultiscaleIntervalRotSpan`

with per-scale interval counts $M_A, M_B : \operatorname{Fin} m \to \mathbb{N}$*, setting* $\beta_A := \max(1,\, 2\sum_j M_A(j))$ *and* $\beta_B := \max(1,\, 2\sum_j M_B(j))$*,*

$$2 \dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) \;\le\; d^2 + d \min(\beta_A, \beta_B).$$

(b) Along any sequence of fields (F_m) *and families* (A_m, B_m) *whose per-scale interval sums* $S_{A,m} := \sum_j M_{A,m}(j)$ *and* $S_{B,m} := \sum_j M_{B,m}(j)$ *satisfy* $\min(S_{A,m}, S_{B,m})/2^m \to 0$ *as* $m \to \infty$*, for every* $\varepsilon > 0$ *one eventually has* $\dim_{F_m} \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A_m, B_m) \le (\frac{1}{2} + \varepsilon)d^2$ *(uniformly for all* $m \ge \lfloor 1/\varepsilon \rfloor + 1$ *whenever* $\min(S_{A,m}, S_{B,m}) \le (\varepsilon/2)\, 2^m$*).*

(c) At the full aligned dyadic profile $M_{\mathrm{full}}(j) = 2^{j+1}$ *(where* $\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} 2^{j+1} = 2d - 2 \ge d$ *for* $m \ge 1$*), aligned dyadic interval-rotation families realize all matrix units and attain* $\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) = d^2$*.*

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), the intervals used in A create at most $2\sum_j M_A(j)$ endpoint cuts around $\mathbb{Z}_d$, partitioning $\operatorname{Fin} d$ into at most β_A contiguous classes on each of which every A_a acts as a fixed linear combination of rotations. Hence $\sum_a A_a X B_a^{\mathsf{T}} = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ defines a β_A-class-uniform code, giving $2\dim_F \le d^2 + d\beta_A$ by [3, Theorem 6.4]. Passing to $Y = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ exchanges A and B via $Y^{\mathsf{T}} = \sum_a B_a Y A_a^{\mathsf{T}}$, giving $2\dim_F \le d^2 + d\beta_B$ as well. Part (b) divides by $2d^2$. In (c), aligned dyadic intervals down to length $2^0 = 1$ span all diagonal projectors $E_{r,r}$ and hence all matrix units $E_{r,c} = E_{r,r}\sigma^{c-r}$ (where $(\sigma v)_a = v_{a+1}$). □

Note the scope of Proposition 7.3: the bound uses only the sparser of the two sides rather than any two-sided interaction between A and B, carries no matching sparse lower bound, and becomes vacuous ($\ge d^2$) as soon as $\min(\beta_A, \beta_B) \ge d$—in particular at the full profile $M_{\mathrm{full}}(j) = 2^{j+1}$ for $m \ge 2$, where $\beta = 4d - 4 > d$.

To exploit sparsity on *both* sides simultaneously over an arbitrary field F, suppose the intervals used on side A separate into a "fine" coordinate set $S_A \subseteq \operatorname{Fin} d$ of cardinality $s_A = |S_A|$ and c_A pairwise-disjoint nonempty coarse cyclic intervals $\mathrm{coarse}_A : \operatorname{Fin} c_A \to \operatorname{Finset}(\operatorname{Fin} d)$ partitioning the complement $L_A := \operatorname{Fin} d \setminus S_A$, so that every A_a lies in the F-span of $\{\texttt{intervalMaskRotMatrix}(F, I, e)\}$ with $I \subseteq S_A$, $I = \mathrm{coarse}_A(i)$, or $I = \operatorname{Fin} d$ (`HasCoarseFineIntervalDecomposition`), and similarly (S_B, c_B) on side B ($s_B = |S_B|$, $L_B = \operatorname{Fin} d \setminus S_B$). For any $S \subseteq \operatorname{Fin} d$, write $\dot{m}(S) := \texttt{cyclicRunEndpointCount}(S) = |\{r \in S : (r+1) \bmod d \notin S\}|$ and $m(S) := \texttt{cyclicRunCount}(S)$ ($= 1$ if $S = \operatorname{Fin} d$ and $\dot{m}(S)$ otherwise, so $\dot{m}(S) \le m(S)$), and set (`theorem3UnsymmetrizedBound`)

$$\begin{aligned} B_{\mathrm{cf}}(d;\, s_A, m_A, c_A;\, s_B, m_B, c_B) \;:=\; & \frac{1}{2}\, d^2 + \frac{1}{4}\, s_B(d - s_A) + \frac{1}{2}\, s_A s_B \\ & + \frac{1}{2}\, c_B d + \frac{1}{4}\, c_A s_B + \frac{1}{2}\, s_B m_A + \frac{1}{4}\, m_B(d - s_A). \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 7.4 (Characteristic-free two-sided coarse–fine bound for interval-rotation swap codes)**.**
Lean: `extension_Theorem3_TwoSidedCoarseFine`, `swapCode_finrank_le_twoSidedCoarseFine` [`ExtensionTwoSidedProfileProofs.lean`]

Let F *be* any *field (of arbitrary characteristic), let* $d \ge 1$*, let* α *be a finite index type, and let* $A, B : \alpha \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ *satisfy* `HasCoarseFineIntervalDecomposition` (S_A, c_A, A) *and* `HasCoarseFineIntervalDecomposition` (S_B, c_B, B) *with* $s_A = |S_A|$ *and* $s_B = |S_B|$*. Then with either* $(m_A, m_B) = (\dot{m}(S_A), \dot{m}(S_B))$ *or* $(m_A, m_B) = (m(S_A), m(S_B))$*,*

$$\begin{aligned} \dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) \;\le\; \min\Big(& B_{\mathrm{cf}}(d;\, s_A, m_A, c_A;\, s_B, m_B, c_B), \\ & B_{\mathrm{cf}}(d;\, s_B, m_B, c_B;\, s_A, m_A, c_A)\Big). \end{aligned}$$

Outline of the formal proof. Identify $\mathrm{Fin}\, d$ with $\mathbb{Z}_d$ and let $K(X) := \sum_{a\in\alpha} A_a X B_a^{\mathsf{T}}$, so $\mathcal{X} :=$ `SwapRigidity.swapCode`$(A, B) = \{X : X^{\mathsf{T}} = K(X)\}$.

1. *Corner perturbation*: subtracting the fine-by-fine corner $X \mapsto P_{S_A} K(X) P_{S_B}$ (where $(P_S v)_a = \mathbf{1}_{a\in S}\, v_a$, image dimension $\le s_A s_B$) gives $\dim_F \mathcal{X} \le s_A s_B + \dim_F \mathcal{Y}$, where $\mathcal{Y} := \{X : X^{\mathsf{T}} = K(X) - P_{S_A} K(X) P_{S_B}\}$. Every $X \in \mathcal{Y}$ has $(X^{\mathsf{T}})_{r,c} = 0$ on $S_A \times S_B$, i.e. $X_{b,a} = 0$ for all $(b, a) \in S_B \times S_A$.

2. *Column-shift Grassmann step*: for $\sigma_{\mathrm{col}}(X)_{b,a} := X_{b,a+1}$, the sum $\mathcal{Y} + \sigma_{\mathrm{col}}^{-1}(\mathcal{Y})$ vanishes on $S_B \times \{a \in S_A : a - 1 \in S_A\}$ of cardinality $s_B(s_A - \dot{m}(S_A))$, so $2\dim_F \mathcal{Y} + s_B(s_A - \dot{m}(S_A)) \le d^2 + \dim_F \mathcal{Y}_1$ where $\mathcal{Y}_1 := \mathcal{Y} \cap \sigma_{\mathrm{col}}^{-1}(\mathcal{Y})$.

3. *B-side coarse anchors*: along each B-coarse interval $\mathrm{coarse}_B(j)$ with start $\mathrm{start}_B(j)$, shift covariance of the B_a forces $X_{b+1,a} = X_{b,a+1}$ across all $a \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ for every $X \in \mathcal{Y}_1$ and every interior step of $\mathrm{coarse}_B(j)$. Setting the $c_B d$ anchor entries $X_{\mathrm{start}_B(j),a} = 0$ defines $\mathcal{Z}_0 \le \mathcal{Y}_1$ with $\dim_F \mathcal{Y}_1 \le c_B d + \dim_F \mathcal{Z}_0$, and every $X \in \mathcal{Z}_0$ vanishes outside $S_B \times L_A$.

4. *Row-shift Grassmann step*: for $\sigma_{\mathrm{row}}(X)_{b,a} := X_{b+1,a}$, the sum $\mathcal{Z}_0 + \sigma_{\mathrm{row}}^{-1}(\mathcal{Z}_0)$ is supported inside $(S_B \cup (S_B + 1)) \times L_A$ of size at most $(s_B + \dot{m}(S_B))(d - s_A)$, while on $\mathcal{Z}_1 := \mathcal{Z}_0 \cap \sigma_{\mathrm{row}}^{-1}(\mathcal{Z}_0)$ shift covariance of the A_a along each A-coarse interval forces $X_{b,\mathrm{start}_A(i)+u} = X_{b+u,\mathrm{start}_A(i)}$, injecting $\mathcal{Z}_1$ into $F^{\mathrm{Fin}\, c_A \times S_B}$ of dimension $c_A s_B$. Hence $2\dim_F \mathcal{Z}_0 \le (s_B + \dot{m}(S_B))(d - s_A) + c_A s_B$.

Combining steps 1–4 gives $\dim_F \mathcal{X} \le B_{\mathrm{cf}}(d;\, s_A, \dot{m}(S_A), c_A;\, s_B, \dot{m}(S_B), c_B)$; transposing $Y = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ swaps (A, S_A, c_A) with (B, S_B, c_B), and monotonicity in (m_A, m_B) gives the $m(S)$ form since $d - s_A \ge 0$. □

On the concrete family `InContiguousCoarseFineSpan` generated on side A by s_A contiguous singleton masks $\{0\}, \ldots, \{s_A - 1\}$ (`contiguousFineSet`, $m_A = 1$) together with one complementary coarse interval $\{s_A, \ldots, d - 1\}$ (`contiguousCoarseComplement`, $c_A = 1$) and full rotations—and analogously s_B contiguous singletons plus one coarse complement on side B—one-sided endpoint refinement (Proposition 7.3) sees $s_A{+}1$ and $s_B{+}1$ intervals and gives leading coefficient $\frac{1}{2}{+}\frac{1}{2}\min(\alpha, \beta)$ (where $\alpha = s_A/d$ and $\beta = s_B/d$), whereas Theorem 7.4 achieves a strictly smaller leading coefficient for all $\alpha, \beta \in (0, 1)$:

Corollary 7.5 (Strict two-sided win over one-sided Theorem TP and $\frac{11}{16}d^2 + d$ benchmark)**.** `Lean`: `extension_Theorem3_ConcreteWinOverTP`, `swapCode_finrank_le_contiguousCoarseFine` [`ExtensionTwoSidedProfileProofs.lean`]

(a) For all real $\alpha, \beta \in (0, 1)$,

$$\frac{1}{2} \;+\; \frac{1}{4}\min\big(\beta(1+\alpha),\ \alpha(1+\beta)\big) \;<\; \frac{1}{2} \;+\; \frac{1}{2}\min(\alpha, \beta).$$

(b) For every field F, every finite index type α_0, every $d \ge 2$, every $1 \le s_A, s_B < d$ ($\alpha := s_A/d$, $\beta := s_B/d$), and all $A, B : \alpha_0 \to \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ satisfying `InContiguousCoarseFineSpan` (s_A, A) *and* `InContiguousCoarseFineSpan` (s_B, B)*, both sides satisfy* `HasCoarseFineIntervalDecomposition` *with $c_A = c_B = m_A = m_B = 1$, and*

$$\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) \;\le\; \left(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\min\big(\beta(1+\alpha),\ \alpha(1+\beta)\big)\right) d^2 \;+\; \frac{5}{4}\, d.$$

(c) At the half-fine benchmark $d = 2k$ ($k \geq 1$) with $s_A = s_B = k$ ($\alpha = \beta = 1/2$), one has $B_{\mathrm{cf}}(2k;\, k,1,1;\, k,1,1) = \frac{11}{16}\, d^2 + d$ ($\frac{11}{16} = 0.6875 < \frac{3}{4}$), so every pair A, B in `InContiguousCoarseFineSpan` (k) *satisfies*

$$\dim_F \texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B) \;\leq\; \frac{11}{16}\, d^2 + d,$$

which is strictly less than $\frac{3}{4}\, d^2$ for all even $d = 2k \geq 18$ ($k \geq 9$).

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), assuming $\alpha \leq \beta$ by symmetry gives $\min(\beta(1+\alpha), \alpha(1+\beta)) \leq \alpha(1+\beta) < 2\alpha = 2\min(\alpha, \beta)$ since $\alpha > 0$ and $1 + \beta < 2$. In (b), $\texttt{contiguousFineSet}(s)$ has cardinality s and a single cyclic run ($m = 1$) while $\texttt{contiguousCoarseComplement}(s)$ is a single cyclic interval of length $d - s$ ($c = 1$), and substituting $c_A = c_B = m_A = m_B = 1$ into Theorem 7.4 yields $\frac{1}{2}d^2 + \frac{1}{4}s_B d + \frac{1}{4}s_A s_B + \frac{1}{2}d + \frac{3}{4}s_B + \frac{1}{4}(d - s_A) \leq (\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\beta(1+\alpha))d^2 + \frac{5}{4}d$ when $s_B \leq s_A$ (and symmetrically when $s_A \leq s_B$). Part (c) evaluates $B_{\mathrm{cf}}(2k;\, k,1,1;\, k,1,1) = 2k^2 + \frac{1}{4}k^2 + \frac{1}{2}k^2 + k + \frac{1}{4}k + \frac{1}{2}k + \frac{1}{4}k = \frac{11}{4}k^2 + 2k = \frac{11}{16}d^2 + d$, which satisfies $\frac{11}{16}d^2 + d < \frac{3}{4}d^2 \iff d > 16 \iff k \geq 9$. □

Remark 7.6 (Numerical: small-grid SVD values for two-sided interval partitions)**.** Across small two-sided interval partitions tested numerically by singular-value decomposition over $\mathbb{R}$ at $d \in \{5, 6, 7, 8\}$ (not formalized; no proof in this paper uses this computation), the largest observed dimension of $\texttt{SwapRigidity.swapCode}(A, B)$ matched the sharper expression $\lfloor \frac{1}{2}(d^2 + \sum_{i,j} \min(|I_i|, |J_j|)) \rfloor$, which would give $\frac{5}{8}d^2 + O(d)$ at $\alpha = \beta = 1/2$ (attained by swapping one boundary entry per singleton). Whether that formula holds for all two-sided interval partitions remains open.

By contrast, if "scale-j dyadic mask" means the periodic Walsh/Rademacher bit projector $P_{W_j,\mathrm{bit}}$ onto $\{r \in \mathrm{Fin}(2^m) : \mathrm{bit}_j(r) = \mathrm{bit}\}$ (bit $\in \{0, 1\}$; `walshBitSet`, `walshDigitMaskRotMatrix`, `IsPeriodicScaleDyadicMask`), then a single mask per scale has exponentially many boundaries at fine scales, so one-sided endpoint refinement becomes vacuous even though only two periodic masks per scale are used:

Proposition 7.7 (Cyclic boundaries and operator-span dimension for periodic Walsh masks)**.** Lean: `walshDigitMask_in_periodicDyadicSpan` [`SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean`]
Lean: `walshBitSet_cyclicBoundaryCount`, `isCyclicInterval_cyclicBoundaryCount_le_two`, `isPeriodicScaleDyadicMask_cyclicBoundaryCount`, `walshBitSet_joint_separates_points`, `walshDigitMaskRotSpan_finrank_le`, `bonus2_WalshDichotomyStructuralProperties` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]
Let $m \geq 0$ and $d = 2^m$.

(a) Every cyclic interval $I \subseteq \mathrm{Fin}\, d$ ($d \geq 1$) satisfies $\texttt{cyclicBoundaryCount}(I) \leq 2$*, whereas for each $j \in \mathrm{Fin}\, m$, both $W_j =$* $\texttt{walshBitSet}(m, j)$ *and every periodic scale-j mask (*`IsPeriodicScaleDyadicMask`*) have* `cyclicBoundaryCount` $= 2^{j+1}$ *(at least 4 once $j \geq 1$).*

(b) Across $j \in \mathrm{Fin}\, m$, the m Walsh bit sets $W_0, \ldots, W_{m-1}$ jointly separate $\mathrm{Fin}(2^m)$ into 2^m singleton atoms.

(c) Over every field F, every family in the span of $\{\texttt{walshDigitMaskRotMatrix}(F, j, \mathrm{bit}, s) : j \in \mathrm{Fin}\, m,\ \mathrm{bit} \in \{0, 1\},\ s \in \mathrm{Fin}(2^m)\}$ *belongs to* `InMultiscalePeriodicDyadicRotSpan` *with constant profile $M(j) = 2$ per scale ($\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} M(j) = 2m = 2\log_2 d$), and the entire Walsh-masked rotation span has dimension at most $(m+1)2^m$ over F.*

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), W_j alternates blocks of 2^{m-1-j} zeros and 2^{m-1-j} ones 2^j times around $\mathrm{Fin}(2^m)$, producing 2^{j+1} boundary transitions, and any periodic scale-j mask is a cyclic translate of W_j or its complement. Part (b) recovers $r \in \mathrm{Fin}(2^m)$ from its m binary digits. In (c), the two bit values bit $\in \{0,1\}$ at scale j give two periodic scale-j masks ($M(j) = 2$), while $P_{W_j,0}\sigma^s + P_{W_j,1}\sigma^s = \sigma^s$ shows that the span is generated by the 2^m pure rotations together with the $m \cdot 2^m$ operators $P_{W_j,1}\sigma^s$. □

Whether $\dim_F$ `SwapRigidity.swapCode`(A, B) is bounded away from d^2 when both A and B lie in the $(m+1)2^m$-dimensional Walsh-masked rotation span remains open.

8 Restricted shuffle-and-local operator pipelines and anti-diagonal untwisting

We state the scope of this section up front. In Section 8.1 we analyze Operator Schmidt Rank ($\mathrm{rk}_\otimes$) across the row/column tensor cut $F^d_{\mathrm{row}} \otimes_F (F^d_{\mathrm{col}} \otimes_F F^b)$ for linear pipelines built from Stone's shuffle and unshuffle [13] together with row-uniform operators $I_d \otimes B$ and column-uniform operators $A \otimes I_{db}$. This invariant applies *only* to that restricted operator pipeline: it *does not* answer [3, Problem 9.5] and *does not* yield a lower bound for Turing machines. Indeed, Problem 9.5 of [3] asks for a functional that is subadditive over machine steps, large for the swap at every scale, and *"not raised at all scales by a single linear-time operation"*, whereas within-row cyclic shear has $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes = d$ (Proposition 8.5(a)) yet is computed in $O(L)$ steps on a 2-work-tape Turing machine (Proposition 8.4). Nor do we formalize a converse decomposition of τ into m shuffle passes here; Theorem 8.3 is a pass lower bound for the specified operator class.

8.1 Operator Schmidt Rank on restricted shuffle pipelines and linear-time machines

Write `GridState`$(F, d, b) := (\mathrm{Fin}\, d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, b \to F)$, separating the row index $r \in \mathrm{Fin}\, d$ from the within-row column-and-lane index $(c, \ell) \in \mathrm{Fin}\, d \times \mathrm{Fin}\, b$. An F-linear operator K on `GridState`(F, d, b) has *Operator Schmidt Rank at most* R, written $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K) \le R$ (`HasOperatorSchmidtRankLe`), if there exist R row matrices $A_i \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(F)$ and R within-row linear maps $B_i \in \mathrm{End}_F(F^d \otimes_F F^b)$ such that

$$(KX)_{r,c,\ell} \;=\; \sum_{i=0}^{R-1} \sum_{r'=0}^{d-1} (A_i)_{r,r'}\, \big(B_i(X_{r'})\big)_{c,\ell},$$

and we write $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K) = R$ (`HasExactOperatorSchmidtRank`) when $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K) \le R$ and no $R' < R$ suffices.

Lemma 8.1 (Submultiplicativity and unit-rank operators)**.** Lean: `operatorSchmidtRankSubmultiplicative`, `hasOperatorSchmidtRankLe_comp` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]
Lean: `isRowOrColUniform_rankLe_one` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

Over any commutative semiring F (and in particular any field):

(a) If $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K_1) \le R_1$ *and* $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K_2) \le R_2$*, then* $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K_2 \circ K_1) \le R_2 R_1$.

(b) Every row-uniform column operator $I_d \otimes B$ *(*`IsRowUniformColOp`*,* $(KX)_r = B(X_r)$*) and every column-uniform row operator* $A \otimes I_{db}$ *(*`IsColUniformRowOp`*,* $(KX)_{r,c,\ell} = \sum_{r'} A_{r,r'} X_{r',c,\ell}$*) satisfies* $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(K) \le 1$.

Outline of the formal proof. Expanding $K_2 \circ K_1$ over $(i_2, i_1) \in \operatorname{Fin} R_2 \times \operatorname{Fin} R_1$ multiplies the row matrices $A_{2,i_2} A_{1,i_1}$ and composes the within-row maps $B_{2,i_2} \circ B_{1,i_1}$ using $R_2 R_1$ terms; $I_d \otimes B$ and $A \otimes I_{db}$ are single elementary tensors. □

Theorem 8.2 (Operator Schmidt Rank of transpose and Stone's shuffle)**.** Lean: `operatorSchmidtRankSwap`, `operatorSchmidtRankStoneShuffle` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]

Let F be any field and let $b \geq 1$.

(a) For every $d \geq 1$, the matrix transpose $\tau = \texttt{gridSwapLinear}(F, d, b)$ satisfies $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(\tau) = d^2$.

(b) On $d = 2^m$, Stone's 1-bit cyclic shuffle $S = \texttt{stoneShuffleGridLinear}(F, m, b)$ and unshuffle $S^{-1} = \texttt{stoneUnshuffleGridLinear}(F, m, b)$ are mutual inverses with $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(S) \leq 4$ and $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(S^{-1}) \leq 4$ for all $m \geq 0$, and for every $m \geq 1$ ($d = 2^m \geq 2$),

$$\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(S) \;=\; \mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(S^{-1}) \;=\; 4.$$

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), decomposing τ by source/target row pairs uses d^2 terms, and evaluating any R-term decomposition on row-localized lane-0 basis inputs produces R matrices spanning $\mathrm{Mat}_{d \times d}(F)$, forcing $R \geq d^2$. In (b), for $m \geq 1$, Stone's shuffle sends (r, c) to (r', c') by moving the top bit of r into the low bit of c' and the top bit of c into the low bit of r'; splitting on (low bit of c', low bit of r') $\in \{0,1\}^2$ gives a 4-term decomposition whose four nonzero quadrant blocks are linearly independent once $2^m \geq 2$ (and symmetrically for S^{-1}). □

Theorem 8.3 (Pass lower bounds for restricted shuffle-and-local pipelines)**.** Lean: `stoneShufflePipelinePassLowerBound` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]
Lean: `boundedOSRPipelinePassLowerBound` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

Let F be any field and let $b \geq 1$.

(a) On $d = 2^m$ ($m \geq 0$), if an operator list $K_1, \ldots, K_n$ has composition `composeGridOps` equal to τ, where t indices are equal to S or S^{-1} and every remaining operator satisfies `IsRowUniformColOp` or `IsColUniformRowOp` (of the form $I_d \otimes B$ or $A \otimes I_{db}$), then $(2^m)^2 \leq 4^t$ and $t \geq m$.

(b) More generally, for any $d \geq 1$ and $R \geq 1$, if a composed pipeline equals τ with t operators satisfying $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes} \leq R$ and all remaining operators satisfying $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes} \leq 1$, then $d^2 \leq R^t$, and for $R \geq 2$ one has $t \geq \dfrac{2 \log d}{\log R}$.

Outline of the formal proof. By Lemma 8.1 and Theorem 8.2(b), the composed pipeline has $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes} \leq 4^t$ (respectively $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes} \leq R^t$), whereas $\mathrm{rk}_{\otimes}(\tau) = d^2$ by Theorem 8.2(a). Taking real logarithms when $R \geq 2$ gives $2 \log d \leq t \log R$. □

In the shared library `lean-machine` (`LeanMachine.ShuffleShear`), we construct explicit transition tables for one Stone shuffle pass, one Stone unshuffle pass, and within-row cyclic shear, and transport them into `Transpose.TM` in `ShuffleShearBridge.lean`:

Proposition 8.4 (Verified $O(L)$-time multitape Turing machines for shuffle, unshuffle, and row shear)**.** Lean: `stoneShuffleTM_threeTape_linear`, `stoneUnshuffleTM_twoTape_linear`, `rowShearTM_twoTape_linear` [`ShuffleShearBridge.lean`]

With $b = \mathrm{entryBits}(d)$ *(*`Transpose.entryBits`*) and* $L = \mathrm{inputLength}(d) = d^2 b$ *(*`Transpose.inputLength`*):*

(a) `stoneShuffleTransposeTM` *has* 3 *work tapes (*$k = 3$*) and, for every* $m \geq 1$ *(*$d = 2^m$*) and every matrix* A *(*`Transpose.Matrix`*), computes* `stoneShuffleTMMatrix` *on* (m, A) *within* $150L$ *steps.*

(b) `stoneUnshuffleTransposeTM` *has* 2 *work tapes (*$k = 2$*) and, for every* $m \geq 1$ *(*$d = 2^m$*) and every matrix* A *(*`Transpose.Matrix`*), computes* `stoneUnshuffleTMMatrix` *on* (m, A) *within* $150L$ *steps.*

(c) `rowShearTransposeTM` *has* 2 *work tapes (*$k = 2$*) and, for every* $d \geq 1$ *and every matrix* A *(*`Transpose.Matrix`*), computes within-row cyclic shear* `rowShearTMMatrix` *on* (d, A) *(sending entry* (r, c, ℓ) *to* $A_{r,(c+r) \bmod d,\ell}$*) within* $200L$ *steps.*

Outline of the formal proof. Because d and b are not hardcoded in the finite control, the machines in `LeanMachine.ShuffleShear` first determine unary counters for b and d (or $H = d^2/2$) from the input length $L = d^2 b$ in $O(L)$ steps. The 3-work-tape shuffle machine stores unary counters for b and H on two work tapes, buffers the first H words on a third work tape, and interleaves b-bit words from the buffer and the second half of the input tape. The 2-work-tape unshuffle machine emits even-indexed b-bit words directly from the input tape while buffering odd-indexed words on tape 0 using a unary b-counter on tape 1, then replays tape 0. The 2-work-tape row-shear machine copies each db-bit row to tape 0 and emits it cyclically shifted by rb bits. `computesWithin_toTransposeTM` transports each proof identically to `Transpose.ComputesWithin`. □

Two controls clarify the boundary of $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes$ and of single-cell information measures:

Proposition 8.5 (Within-row shear $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes = d$ and row-diagonal source-arity gauge invariance)**.** Lean: `control_RowShearAndRowDiagonalAlternation` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]
Lean: `rowDiagonal_SourceArityGaugeInvariance` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

Let F *be any field,* $d \geq 1$*, and* $b \geq 1$*.*

(a) Within-row cyclic shear `rowShearLinear` *on* (F, d, b) *lies in the row-diagonal subalgebra* `IsRowDiagonalOp` *(*$(KX)_r = B_r(X_r)$*) yet has operator Schmidt rank* d*.*

(b) Output-row source arity (`HasOutputRowSourceArityLe`*) is invariant under two-sided composition* $D_1 \circ K \circ D_0$ *with arbitrary row-diagonal operators* D_0, D_1 *(over any commutative semiring* F*), whereas* $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes(\mathrm{id}) \leq 1 < d = \mathrm{rk}_\otimes(\mathcal{S}_{d,b} \circ \mathrm{id})$ *separates* $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes$ *from row-diagonal gauge invariance for all* $d \geq 2$ *(writing* $\mathcal{S}_{d,b} :=$ `rowShearLinear`(F, d, b)*).*

(c) On $d = 2^m$ *(*$m \geq 0$*), every alternating product* $D_t U_t D_{t-1} \cdots U_1 D_0$ *(*`alternatingRowDiagProduct`*) of* $t + 1$ *row-diagonal operators* D_i *and* t *shuffle or unshuffle passes* $U_j \in \{S, S^{-1}\}$ *has output-row source arity at most* 2^t*; if it equals* τ*, then* $2^m \leq 2^t$ *and* $t \geq m$*.*

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), `rowShearLinear` $= \sum_{r=0}^{d-1} E_{r,r} \otimes \sigma^r$ (where $(\sigma v)_{c,\ell} = v_{c+1,\ell}$), and linear independence of the d cyclic column shifts $\sigma^0, \ldots, \sigma^{d-1}$ forces $\mathrm{rk}_\otimes = d$. In (b) and (c), row-diagonal operators act within each row without mixing source rows, while each S or S^{-1} combines at most two source rows into each output row; since row 0 of $\tau(X)$ depends on all 2^m input rows when $b \geq 1$, equality with τ forces $2^m \leq 2^s$. □

Proposition 8.6 (Skew one-time-pad zero-mutual-information control)**.** Lean: `control_SkewOneTimePadInformationTrap` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]
Lean: `uniformShannonMI_eq_zero_of_indep`, `skewOneTimePad_ShannonMutualInfoZero` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

For $d \geq 1$ and $b \geq 1$, define $W(X) := X^{\mathsf{T}} \oplus X$ on $\{0,1\}^{d\times d\times b}$ (`skewXorPad`). Then $W(X) \oplus X = X^{\mathsf{T}}$ for every X, and under uniformly random X, every single entry $W_{r,c}$ is statistically independent of every target column $X_{:,c'}$, so its discrete Shannon mutual information (`uniformShannonMI`) satisfies

$$I(W_{r,c}\,;\, X_{:,c'}) \;=\; 0 \qquad \text{for all } r, c, c' \in \mathbb{Z}_d.$$

Outline of the formal proof. When $r = c$, $W_{r,r} = 0$ is constant. When $r \neq c$, the two entries $X_{c,r}$ and $X_{r,c}$ lie in distinct columns $r \neq c$, so at least one lies outside column c' and acts as an independent uniform pad on the other, giving exact product-count independence and zero Shannon mutual information. □

8.2 Anti-diagonal untwisting of shift-collision equations

We close this section with a coordinate observation on linear codes with deterministic shared decoders (`SharedDecoders.IsSharedCode`, [8, Section 2]) and the shift-link covariance spaces of [3, Section 6]. Untwisting matrix coordinates along anti-diagonals $a = c + j \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ via the mutually inverse F-linear maps (`antiDiagLinear`, `fromAntiDiagLinear`)

$$Z_{c,a} \;:=\; X_{c,\,a-c}, \qquad X_{c,j} \;=\; Z_{c,\,j+c} \qquad (c, a, j \in \mathbb{Z}_d)$$

induces for $d \geq 1$ the linear tensor isomorphism $\Psi = \texttt{antiDiagTensorEquiv} : (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F) \otimes_F (\mathbb{Z}_d \to A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$ sending $u \otimes v$ to $(c, j) \mapsto u_c\, v_{j+c}$.

Theorem 8.7 (Pairwise shift-collision characterization and anti-diagonal tensor separation)**.** Lean: `pairwiseShiftCollisionCharacterization`, `antiDiagonalTensorSeparation` [`OperatorDualityProofs.lean`]
Lean: `antiDiagTensorEquiv_intertwines_rot`, `shiftSetCovariance_tensor_finrank` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

Let F be a field, $d \geq 1$, A an F-vector space, and $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$.

(a) A linear subspace $C \leq \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$ satisfies `SharedDecoders.IsSharedCode` for p if and only if for every shift $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ and every $Y \in C$ with $\mathrm{rot}_s(Y) \in C$, Y lies in `InPairwiseShiftCovariance`: whenever $p(c) = p(c + s)$, one has $Y_{c+s,\,j} = Y_{c,\,j+s}$ for all $j \in \mathbb{Z}_d$.

(b) Under $\Psi : (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F) \otimes_F (\mathbb{Z}_d \to A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$, column rotation rot_t intertwines with the pure right-factor coordinate shift $\mathrm{id} \otimes \sigma^t$ (`coordShiftLinear`, $(\sigma^t v)_a = v_{a+t}$).

(c) For any shift set $E \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d$, a matrix $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$ lies in the shift-set covariance subspace $H_E(p)$ (`shiftSetCovarianceSubmodule`) if and only if its anti-diagonal coordinates $Z_{c,a} = X_{c,a-c}$ are constant in c on every connected component of `SwapRigidity.Link` $p\ E$ (`antiDiagonalTensorSeparation`). When $\dim_F A < \infty$, writing $U_E(p) \leq (\mathbb{Z}_d \to F)$ for the subspace of vectors constant on those components (`leftComponentSubmodule`), Ψ maps $U_E(p) \otimes_F (\mathbb{Z}_d \to A)$ onto $H_E(p)$ and

$$\dim_F H_E(p) \;=\; \dim_F U_E(p) \cdot d \cdot \dim_F A.$$

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), determinism of $f_{p(c)}$ on a linear subspace C means that whenever $X_1, X_2 \in C$ satisfy $p(c_1) = p(c_2)$ and $\mathrm{rot}_{c_1}(X_1) = \mathrm{rot}_{c_2}(X_2)$, row c_1 of X_1 equals row c_2 of X_2; setting $s = c_2 - c_1$ and $Y = X_1 - \mathrm{rot}_{-s}(X_2) \in C$ gives $\mathrm{rot}_s(Y) = \mathrm{rot}_s(X_1) - X_2 \in C$ and the pairwise identity. In (b), $\Psi(\mathrm{id} \otimes \sigma^t(u \otimes v))_{c,j} = u_c v_{j+c+t} = \mathrm{rot}_t(\Psi(u \otimes v))_{c,j}$. In (c), substituting $X_{c,j} = Z_{c,j+c}$ turns $X_{c',j+\delta'} = X_{c,j+\delta}$ under $c + \delta = c' + \delta'$ into $Z_{c',a} = Z_{c,a}$ independently for each anti-diagonal $a = c + \delta + j$. □

Proposition 8.8 (Two-subspace Grassmann relaxation and alternating-mask shift separation)**.**
Lean: `maskFloor_GenericSubspaceRealization` [`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`]

Let F be a field, $d \geq 1$, and A a finite-dimensional F-vector space.

(a) For any $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \kappa$, any shift $s \in \mathbb{Z}_d$, and any subspaces $C_0, C_s \leq \mathrm{Mat}_{d\times d}(A)$ with $\dim_F C_0 = \dim_F C_s$ and $C_0 \cap C_s \leq H_{\{0,s\}}(p)$, Grassmann modularity gives $2\dim_F C_0 \leq d^2 \dim_F A + \dim_F H_{\{0,s\}}(p)$. Conversely, once the right-factor shift coupling $C_s = \mathrm{rot}_{-s}(C_0)$ is dropped, splitting a complement of $U_{\{0,s\}}(p)$ in $(\mathbb{Z}_d \to F)$ into two equal-sized subspaces constructs $C_0 = \Psi(V_0 \otimes \top)$ and $C_s = \Psi(V_s \otimes \top)$ with $C_0 \cap C_s = H_{\{0,s\}}(p)$, $\dim_F C_0 = \dim_F C_s$, and

$$d^2 \dim_F A + \dim_F H_{\{0,s\}}(p) \;\leq\; 2\dim_F C_0 + d \dim_F A.$$

(b) On even $d = 2m$ ($m \geq 2$) with the alternating parity partition $p : \mathbb{Z}_{2m} \to \mathrm{Bool}$ ($p(c) =$ `true` $\iff$ c is odd, for $c \in \{0, \ldots, 2m-1\}$), shift $s = 1$ satisfies $p(c) \neq p(c+1)$ everywhere so $U_{\{0,1\}}(p) = \top$ and $H_{\{0,1\}}(p) = \top$, whereas shift $s = 2$ has $\dim_F U_{\{0,2\}}(p) = 2$ and forces $2\dim_F C \leq ((2m)^2 + 4m)\dim_F A$ for every shared code C.

Outline of the formal proof. Part (a) applies $\dim(C_0 + C_s) + \dim(C_0 \cap C_s) = 2\dim C_0$ for the upper bound, and chooses disjoint sets of $\lfloor (d - \dim U_{\{0,s\}}(p))/2 \rfloor$ non-representative indices on the left tensor factor for the converse construction. Part (b) checks that shift 1 has no monochromatic links on the alternating coloring while shift 2 connects all even indices and all odd indices into two components. □

9 Cut-cone evaluation, random-order capacity, and per-entry cut labels

9.1 Cut-causal cone evaluation on frozen `Transpose.TM` fibres

Let M be a deterministic multitape Turing machine (`Transpose.TM`) with $1 \leq M.k$ (available without loss of generality for any transposer by Lemma 2.3), and let $C \subseteq \Sigma_d^{d\times d}$ be a frozen-trace Γ-cut fibre (`IsFrozenTraceCutFibre`) over a step horizon T: all $X \in C$ halt at step T with output X^{T}, follow a common input/work head trajectory (inPos, workPos) and output emission schedule emitStep, and agree on the post-step control state and written work-tape symbols at every cut step $u \in \Gamma \subseteq \{0, \ldots, T-1\}$. Along workPos, a direct causal step $u \to v$ (`TMDepStep`) holds for $u < v < T$ when either $v = u + 1$ (the control-state spine edge) or u is the most recent step visiting the cell scanned by one of the $M.k$ work heads at step v (`IsLastWorkVisit`). A descending path is Γ-free (`IsCutFreeCausalPath`) if none of its strict predecessors lies in Γ; the resulting Γ-truncated causal cone of step v is `trueConeSteps` (`InCutCausalCone`), and its syntactic input-cell support is `cutConeInputCells`.

In `MachineSweepConsequences.lean`, we also represent each cone syntactically as a rooted $(1 + M.k)$-ary symbolic tree (`CausalConeTree`) extracted relative to column c (`traceConeTree`) and evaluated bottom-up on $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ directly through $M.\delta$ (`evalConeTree`, syntactic support `treeCellSupport`):

Lemma 9.1 (Syntactic cut-cone support and symbolic tree evaluation on frozen fibres)**.** Lean: `tmTraceCutConeDetermination` [`NativeSweepInterfaceProofs.lean`]

Lean: `evalConeTree_cellSupport`, `evalConeTree_entryCellSupport_card_le`, `evalConeTree_traceConeTree_eq` [`MachineSweepConsequences.lean`]

Let M be a `Transpose.TM` *with $1 \le M.k$, let $d \ge 1$ and $D \ge 1$, and let $C \subseteq \Sigma_d^{d\times d}$ satisfy* `IsFrozenTraceCutFibre` *such that every Γ-free causal path π has at most D vertices (π.length $\le D$).*

(a) For every step $v < T$, $|\texttt{trueConeSteps}(\mathrm{workPos}, T, \Gamma, v)| \le (M.k+1)^D$. For every output bit (r, c, ℓ) emitted at step $v = \mathrm{emitStep}(\texttt{outputBitIdx}(d, r, c, \ell))$, the explicit syntactic cone support $Q_{\mathrm{bit}} := \texttt{cutConeInputCells}(d, T, \mathrm{inPos}, \mathrm{workPos}, \Gamma, v)$ consists of those cells visited by inPos *on* `trueConeSteps`*, satisfies $|Q_{\mathrm{bit}}| \le (M.k+1)^D$, and uniquely determines $X_{c,r,\ell}$ across C: whenever $X_1, X_2 \in C$ agree on Q_{bit}, one has $X_1(c, r, \ell) = X_2(c, r, \ell)$.*

(b) Every depth-D `CausalConeTree` *has $|\texttt{treeCellSupport}(\mathrm{tree})| \le (M.k+1)^D$ and depends on $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ only through* `treeCellSupport`(tree)*. Given any cut-value assignment* cutVal *agreeing with the frozen Γ-cut states and work symbols on C, evaluating* `traceConeTree` *at depth D on $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$ ($X \in C$) via* `evalConeTree` *reproduces the post-step control state, written work symbols, and emitted output bit $X_{c,r,\ell}$ of the live machine run. Across all $b = \texttt{Transpose.entryBits}(d)$ bit-lane trees of an output entry, the union of* `treeCellSupport` *has size at most $\Delta = b(M.k+1)^D$.*

Outline of the formal proof. Each step $w < T$ has at most $1 + M.k$ direct causal predecessors ($w-1$ for the control state and at most one last-visit step per work tape), so inducting on the depth budget $m \le D$ gives the geometric sum bound $1 + (M.k+1)((M.k+1)^{m-1} - 1) < (M.k+1)^m$. Defining $Q_{\mathrm{bit}} =$ `cutConeInputCells` explicitly as the union of input cells read along `trueConeSteps` avoids self-referential singleton footprints: strong induction on $w < T$ shows that inputs in C agreeing on Q_{bit} induce identical transitions $M.\delta$ throughout the Γ-stopped cone of v, and `evalConeTree` replays those exact transitions bottom-up from initial blank leaves and frozen Γ-cut leaves on $\mathrm{rot}_c(X)$. □

9.2 Lean formalization of the $1/(\Delta+1)$ random-order bound for shared set codes

For any recovery relation of maximum footprint size Δ, the acyclic-subgraph bound of Bar-Yossef, Birk, Jayram, and Kol [1, Theorem 3] combined with a uniformly random vertex ordering gives a maximum acyclic induced subgraph of size at least $(\#\mathrm{clean})/(\Delta+1)$ and hence rate at most $1 - 1/(\Delta+1)$ up to self-referential entries. This elementary bound has been in the series since [4, Proposition 4.14(a)–(b)] (proved in text there, with the $1 - 1/(\Delta+1)$ and acyclic-subgraph forms recalled in [3, Sections 4.1 and 6.7]). We record its Lean 4 formalization in the notation of Definition 2.2.

Given $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Fin}\, M$ and $Q : \mathrm{Fin}\, M \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathrm{Finset}(\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d)$, evaluating $f_{p(c)}(\mathrm{rot}_c(X))_r$ reads the shifted footprint (`shiftedFootprint`)

$$F_{c,r} \;:=\; \{(r',\, c+u) \;:\; (r', u) \in Q_{p(c),r}\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d,$$

and an input entry (c, r) is *clean* (`cleanEntries`) if $(r, c) \notin \mathcal{E}$ and $(c, r) \notin F_{c,r}$. Note that decoder sharing enters the following bound *only* through the $dM\Delta$ count of self-referential entries $(c, r) \in F_{c,r}$; once clean entries are isolated, the random-order bound uses only the individual footprints $F_{c,r}$.

Lemma 9.2 (Self-referential entries and clean-entry count)**.** Lean: `mem_shiftedFootprint_self_iff`, `selfReferentialAndCleanCount` [`BoundedAritySetCapacityProofs.lean`]

For all $d \geq 1$, $M, \Delta \in \mathbb{N}$, $p : \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Fin} M$, $Q : \operatorname{Fin} M \to \mathbb{Z}_d \to \operatorname{Finset}(\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d)$, and $\mathcal{E} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d$:

(a) $(c, r) \in F_{c,r}$ if and only if $(c, r - c) \in Q_{p(c),r}$.

(b) If $|Q_{m,r}| \leq \Delta$ for all (m, r), then $|F_{c,r}| \leq \Delta$ for every clean entry (c, r) and

$$|\texttt{cleanEntries}(p, Q, \mathcal{E})| \;\geq\; d^2 - |\mathcal{E}| - dM\Delta.$$

Outline of the formal proof. For each fixed (m, r), the map $c \mapsto (c, r - c)$ is injective on $\mathbb{Z}_d$, so at most $|Q_{m,r}| \leq \Delta$ columns $c \in p^{-1}(m)$ satisfy $(c, r) \in F_{c,r}$. Summing over $m \in \operatorname{Fin} M$ and $r \in \mathbb{Z}_d$ bounds self-referential entries by $dM\Delta$. □

Theorem 9.3 (Random-order capacity bound for bounded-arity shared set codes; after [4, Proposition 4.14(a)–(b)] and [1, Theorem 3])**.** Lean: `orderedRecoverable_injective_and_card_le`, `exists_orderedRecoverableCells_bound`, `randomOrder_BoundedAritySetCapacity`, `corollary_OneClassArityOneHalf`, `corollary_OneClassArityTwoTwoThirds`, `asymptotic_SublinearClassesBrokenFractionRefutesRateOne` [`SetCapacityConsequences.lean`]

Let $d \geq 1$, let $M, \Delta \in \mathbb{N}$, let Σ be a finite alphabet with $|\Sigma| \geq 2$, and let $C \subseteq \Sigma^{d \times d}$ satisfy $\texttt{IsBoundedAritySetCode}(\Delta, p, \mathcal{E}, f, Q, C)$.

(a) For every ranking $\mathrm{rk} : \mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d \to \mathbb{N}$, let $A(\mathrm{rk}) := \texttt{orderedRecoverableCells}(p, Q, \mathcal{E}, \mathrm{rk})$ be the set of clean entries (c, r) satisfying $\mathrm{rk}(y) < \mathrm{rk}(c, r)$ for all $y \in F_{c,r}$. Then restriction to $(\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d) \setminus A(\mathrm{rk})$ is injective on C, so $|C| \leq |\Sigma|^{d^2 - |A(\mathrm{rk})|}$, and averaging over all permutations of $\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d$ produces an injective ranking rk_* with $(\Delta + 1)|A(\mathrm{rk}_*)| \geq |\texttt{cleanEntries}(p, Q, \mathcal{E})|$.

(b) Consequently, for every (empty or nonempty) code C,

$$\frac{\log|C|}{\log|\Sigma|} \;\leq\; d^2 \;-\; \frac{d^2 - |\mathcal{E}| - dM\Delta}{\Delta + 1}.$$

At $M = 1, \mathcal{E} = \emptyset$, this gives rate at most $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2d}$ at $\Delta = 1$ and $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3d}$ at $\Delta = 2$; and for any fixed $\Delta \geq 1$, $\delta \in (0, 1]$, any sequence of finite alphabets (Σ_d) with $|\Sigma_d| \geq 2$, $|\mathcal{E}_d| \leq (1 - \delta)d^2$, and $M_d = o(d/\Delta)$, the rate is eventually at most $1 - \frac{\delta}{2(\Delta+1)}$.

Outline of the formal proof. In (a), strong induction on $\mathrm{rk}(c, r)$ shows that two codewords agreeing outside $A(\mathrm{rk})$ agree on $A(\mathrm{rk})$ as well, because every $y \in F_{c,r}$ strictly precedes (c, r). For each clean entry $x = (c, r)$, $|F_{c,r} \cup \{x\}| \leq \Delta + 1$; for a uniformly random permutation π of $\mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d$, composing π with the transposition swapping x and the π-maximum element of $F_{c,r} \cup \{x\}$ partitions the symmetric group so that x comes last in $F_{c,r} \cup \{x\}$ on at least a $1/(\Delta + 1)$ fraction of permutations, and double counting selects rk_*. Combining (a) with Lemma 9.2(b) and $\log|\Sigma| > 0$ gives (b) (with $\log 0 = 0$ in Lean handling $C = \emptyset$). □

Remark 9.4 (Comparison with small-window and unrestricted-arity bounds)**.** In `BoundedAritySetCapacityProofs.lean` and `SetCapacityConsequences.lean` (`oneHopRecoverableInjective`, `existsRecoverableSubsetBound`, `theorem1_BoundedAritySetCapacity`, `growingClassesPositiveDeficit`, and `pMin_two_sided_theta_inv_arity`) we also formalized the weaker one-hop product-Bernoulli variant with factor $\Delta^\Delta/(\Delta + 1)^{\Delta+1} \in \big(1/(e(\Delta + 1)),\, 1/(2(\Delta + 1))\big]$, together with explicit $M = 1, \mathcal{E} = \emptyset$ nonlinear lower bounds for all $d \geq 2$ and $|\Sigma| \geq 2$ (`boundaryCo`

ntrol_DeficitVanishesAtDeltaEqD, unrestrictedArity_RateLowerBoundAndTendstoOne, and unrestrictedArity_ExactLogarithmicAsymptoticAllDimensions): $|C| = \lfloor |\Sigma|^d/d \rfloor^d$ at cell arity $\Delta = d$ (where the clean-entry coefficient $d^2 - dM\Delta$ vanishes), $|C| \geq |\Sigma|^{d(d-1)}$ at whole-column support d and cell arity $\Delta = 2d-1$, and $|C| \geq |\Sigma|^{d^2}/d$ for prime d and $|C| \geq |\Sigma|^{d^2}/(2d)$ for all $d \geq 2$ at $\Delta = d^2$ (wrapping the full-view orbit construction of [8, Theorem A.1 and Corollary A.2], which reaches rate $1 - o(1)$). At $\Delta \leq 2$, stronger results (proved in text, allowing a separate recovery function for each position) are already in [3]: at window $w = 1$, Proposition 6.21(b) of [3] gives the same exponent $|C| \leq q^{(d^2+Md)/2}$ (rate $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2d}$ at $M = 1$) without requiring shared functions, and at window $w \leq 2$, Proposition 6.22(b) of [3] improves on the $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3d}$ bound of Theorem 9.3(b) to $|C| \leq q^{d(d+1)/2+d-1}$ (rate $\frac{1}{2} + O(1/d)$). Meanwhile, Problem 9.4(b) of [3] asks whether rate $\frac{1}{2} + o(1)$ holds at fixed windows $w \geq 3$ over a *fixed* alphabet of q symbols, rather than merely rate < 1.

9.3 Why column classes cannot absorb per-entry cut labels

Remark 9.5 (Why subspace bounds and column-class set capacity stop short of Statement (T))**.** It is natural to ask whether the linear shared-decoder bounds of Sections 3 to 6 or the set-capacity infrastructure of Lemma 9.1 and Theorem 9.3 can bound a periodic stretch of a multitape Turing machine by conditioning on genie advice or a bounded-depth trace cut Γ. Three distinct barriers prevent a direct reduction:

(1) *Nonlinear set fibres versus linear subspaces ([3, Problem 9.4(b)]; [8, Theorem A.1 and Corollary A.2]).* Freezing genie advice or a cut transcript on a finite-alphabet machine selects a *nonlinear subset* $C \subseteq \Sigma_d^{d \times d}$ rather than a linear subspace, so the linear decoder and Fourier-filtration bounds of Sections 3 to 6 do not apply directly. Moreover, Theorem A.1 and Corollary A.2 of [8] prove that shared set decoders with unbounded window reach rate $1 - o(1)$ ($|C| \geq |\Sigma|^{d^2}/(2d)$), so any set-level bridge must enforce a bounded read window.

(2) *Depth-D cut cost exceeds the $1/(\Delta+1)$ deficit ([4, Propositions 4.13 and 4.14(c)], proved in text).* Cutting all causal paths down to length D over a run of length T requires revealing a cut word of bit-cost $\varepsilon L = \Omega(L/D)$, whereas $(M.k+1)^{D+1} > 1/\varepsilon$ and the entry-level cone arity $\Delta = b(M.k+1)^D$ grows exponentially in D (and includes the word-width factor $b = \max(1, \lceil \log_2 d \rceil)$). Thus an $O(1/\Delta)$ rate deficit is always smaller than the cut-advice rate and, as already proved in [4, Proposition 4.14(c)], cannot by itself contradict a transposer.

(3) *Per-entry cut labels from spine edges, and separated high-rate storage codes ([6, 9]).* Even before comparing $1/(\Delta+1)$ against cut advice, for any column class count $M_0 \geq 1$ the numerator $d^2 - |\mathcal{E}| - dM_0\Delta$ in Theorem 9.3(b) is *strictly negative* whenever one attempts to turn a Γ-cut fibre of depth D into a column-class code, either by discarding output entries whose cones touch Γ or by refining column classes using L_{cut} frozen cut slots per column (Proposition 9.6 below). Because `TMDepStep` includes the control-state spine edge $u \to u+1$, every emission step $v \geq D$ encounters a cut step $u \in \Gamma \cap [v-D, v)$ along the spine alone. Cut labels therefore attach to individual output entries rather than whole columns, requiring the *per-position* fixed-alphabet window formulation of [3, Problem 9.4(b)]; and because fast machines can use curved multi-scale head motion across $\Theta(\log d)$ scales rather than uniform home-based passes ([4, Section 3]) while [6, 9] construct bounded-degree paired-distance-separated storage codes above rate $\frac{1}{2}$ and approaching rate 1, graph degree and separation alone cannot rule out linear-time transposition without exploiting one-dimensional head trajectory geometry.

Proposition 9.6 (Negative brackets for per-column cut absorption)**.** `Lean`: `perColumnCutAbsorption_bracket_neg` [`MachineSweepConsequences.lean`]

Let M be a `Transpose.TM` *with $1 \le M.k$, let $d \ge 1$ and $D \in \mathbb{N}$, and let $C \subseteq \Sigma_d^{d\times d}$ be a* nonempty *fibre satisfying* `IsFrozenTraceCutFibre` *whose Γ-free causal paths have at most D vertices. Set $\Delta := $* `Transpose.entryBits`$(d) \cdot (M.k+1)^D$.

(a) Discarding cut-touching outputs*: let $\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{cut}}$ (*`cutTouchingOutputCells` *for d, T,* workPos*,* emitStep*, and Γ) be the set of output coordinates (r,c) having a bit cone that meets Γ along a direct* `TMDepStep`*. Then $d^2 \le |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{cut}}| + D$, and for every $M_0 \ge 1$ and every $\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{sched}} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_d \times \mathbb{Z}_d$, setting $\mathcal{E} := \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{sched}} \cup \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{cut}}$ gives*

$$d^2 - |\mathcal{E}| - dM_0\Delta \;<\; 0.$$

(b) Refining column classes by per-column cut slots*: suppose every cut step $u \in \Gamma$ touched by a bit cone of an unbroken output $(r,c) \notin \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{sched}}$ lies among L_{cut} column-indexed cut slots* $\mathrm{colCutStep}(c) : \mathrm{Fin}\, L_{\mathrm{cut}} \to \mathbb{N}$*. Then $d^2 \le |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{sched}}| + D + dL_{\mathrm{cut}}D$, and for every $M_0 \ge 1$, whenever $(M.q+1)(M.g+1)^{M.k} \ge 2$, the refined class count $M_{\mathrm{cls}} := M_0\big((M.q+1)(M.g+1)^{M.k}\big)^{L_{\mathrm{cut}}}$ satisfies*

$$d^2 - |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{sched}}| - dM_{\mathrm{cls}}\Delta \;<\; 0.$$

Outline of the formal proof. Since $C \neq \emptyset$, the d^2 lane-0 emission steps $v(r,c) = \mathrm{emitStep}(\mathrm{idx}_0(r,c))$ (via `outputBitIdx` at lane 0) are pairwise distinct. For any (r,c) with $v(r,c) \ge D$, the descending control-state spine from $v(r,c)$ cannot avoid Γ for D steps without creating a Γ-free path of $D+1$ vertices; taking the largest $u \in \Gamma \cap [v(r,c)-D, v(r,c))$ places $u+1$ in the Γ-cut cone of $v(r,c)$ with $u \to u+1$, so $(r,c) \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{cut}}$. At most D emission steps satisfy $v(r,c) < D$, giving $d^2 - |\mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{cut}}| \le D < 2^D \le \Delta \le dM_0\Delta$ and proving (a). In (b), each slot $u = \mathrm{colCutStep}(c,s)$ can serve as that most recent cut step for at most D emission steps $v(r,c) \in (u, u+D]$, leaving at most $D + dL_{\mathrm{cut}}D \le d(L_{\mathrm{cut}}+1)D$ unbroken entries; meanwhile $(M.q+1)(M.g+1)^{M.k} \ge 2$ implies $M_{\mathrm{cls}} \ge 2^{L_{\mathrm{cut}}} \ge L_{\mathrm{cut}}+1$, and $D < \Delta$ yields $d(L_{\mathrm{cut}}+1)D < dM_{\mathrm{cls}}\Delta$. □

9.4 Open problems

Statement (T) remains open. Within the models studied in this paper and in [3, 7, 8], four concrete algebraic and combinatorial problems remain unresolved:

1. **Macroscopic rank deficit and positive characteristic in two-stage linear composition.** Can the $\Omega(bd(\log d)^{1/(2M_2-1)})$ error-rank bound of Theorem 4.6 be strengthened to $\Omega_{M_1,M_2}(bd^2)$ for fixed M_1, M_2, and extended to fields in which $\mathrm{char}(F) \mid d$ (such as $\mathbb{F}_2$ at $d = 2^m$)?

2. **Closing $\frac{19}{32}$ to $\frac{1}{2} + o(1)$ and positive characteristics in Problem 9.1(a)–(b).** Can the $\frac{19}{32}\,bd^2 + \frac{3}{2}\,bd^{3/2}$ two-class ceiling of Theorem 5.4 be lowered to $(\frac{1}{2} + o(1))bd^2$ or extended to fields with $\mathrm{char}(F) \mid d$ ([3, Problem 9.1(a)])? And for $\{0,1,3\} \mid \{2,4,5\}$ on $\mathbb{Z}_6$ (Theorem 6.2), what is $D_1(\{0,1,3\},\{2,4,5\})$ over fields of characteristic 2 ($25 \le D_1 \le 28$) and characteristic 3 ($24 \le D_1 \le 28$, [7, Problem 6.1])?

3. **Remaining dimensions in Remark 5.6, sharp two-sided interval bounds, and Walsh-masked swap codes in Problem 9.3.** Does any three-term swap code exceed $d(d+1)/2$ at $d = 5$ or at any $d \ge 8$ outside $\{9, 12\}$ ([3, Remark 5.6])? Does the conjectured $\lfloor \frac{1}{2}(d^2 + \sum_{i,j} \min(|I_i|, |J_j|)) \rfloor$ bound of Remark 7.6 hold for all two-sided interval partitions? And on $d = 2^m$, when both A_a and B_a lie in the $(m+1)2^m$-dimensional span of periodic Walsh digit masks composed with rotations (Proposition 7.7), is $\dim_F$ `SwapRigidity.swapCode`$(A,B) \le (1-c)d^2$ for a constant $c > 0$ ([3, Problem 9.3])?

4. **Per-position fixed-alphabet windows and machine reductions ([3, Problems 9.4 and 9.5]).** Over a fixed finite alphabet of q symbols and a fixed window $w \geq 3$ on a spread one-class relation, does the $\frac{1}{2} + o(1)$ rate bound hold with a separate recovery function for each position ([3, Problem 9.4(b)]), as needed when cut labels vary from entry to entry (Remark 9.5)? Beyond periodic stretches, finding a machine-level reduction from adaptive schedules or a subadditive multi-scale invariant that is unaffected by single linear-time operations such as within-row shear ([3, Problems 9.4(a) and 9.5]) remains the central barrier to Statement (T).

A Formalization architecture

The Lean 4 formalization is split between the shared repository package `lean-machine` (`../lean-machine`) and this paper's package `BoundedArityDecoders` (`lean/`), both pinned to Lean 4 and Mathlib version `v4.34.1` [14]. Through Lake path dependencies in `lean/lakefile.toml`, `BoundedArityDecoders` requires `SharedDecoders` ([8], which transitively imports `SwapRigidity` from [3] and `Transpose` from [5]), `ClassUniformMemo` ([7]), and `LeanMachine`. None of the earlier papers is modified, and for this paper `lean-machine` is extended only by registering four reusable modules under `LeanMachine/ShuffleShear/` in the package root, axiom audit, and `README`:

- `Model.lean`, `StoneShuffle.lean`, `StoneUnshuffle.lean`, and `RowShear.lean`: standalone deterministic multitape Turing machine semantics and verified linear-time machines for Stone's shuffle (3 work tapes, $\leq 150L$ steps), Stone's unshuffle (2 work tapes, $\leq 150L$ steps), and within-row cyclic shear (2 work tapes, $\leq 200L$ steps).

Inside `lean/BoundedArityDecoders/`, twenty-seven public modules are organized into three layers:

(1) *Nine definition and specification modules* (`AffineCubeComposition.lean`, `SumsetRankDeficit.lean`, `ExtensionLinearRun.lean`, `ExtensionAperiodicSix.lean`, `ExtensionTwoSidedProfile.lean`, `SwapCodeAnswers.lean`, `OperatorDuality.lean`, `NativeSweepInterface.lean`, and `BoundedAritySetCapacity.lean`), defining the algebraic operators, one-stage linear run-extension invariants, coarse–fine interval decompositions, syntactic causal cones, and named proposition types;

(2) *Eleven primary proof modules* (`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean`, `SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean`, `ExtensionLinearRunSingleShift.lean`, `ExtensionLinearRunSharpness.lean`, `ExtensionLinearRunProofs.lean`, `ExtensionAperiodicSixProofs.lean`, `ExtensionTwoSidedProfileProofs.lean`, `SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean`, `OperatorDualityProofs.lean`, `NativeSweepInterfaceProofs.lean`, and `BoundedAritySetCapacityProofs.lean`), proving the two-stage composition theorems, the one-stage linear run-extension and $\mathbb{Z}_6$ bounds, the two-sided coarse–fine swap-code bound, and the finite controls; and

(3) *Seven consequence, transfer, and bridge modules* (`ExtensionFieldTransfer.lean`, `AffineCubeConsequences.lean`, `SumsetRankConsequences.lean`, `DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean`, `ShuffleShearBridge.lean`, `MachineSweepConsequences.lean`, and `SetCapacityConsequences.lean`), proving the algebraic-closure primitive-root and scalar-extension transfer lemmas, the explicit constants $c(M_1, M_2)$ and $D_0(M_1, M_2)$, the general-field finite controls at $d = 13$, $d = 4$, and $d = 12$, the `TensorProduct` anti-diagonal equivalences, the transport of `LeanMachine.ShuffleShear` to `Transpose.TM`, the symbolic `CausalConeTree` evaluator, the $1/(\Delta + 1)$ random-order bound, and the negative per-column cut-absorption bounds.

Every numbered theorem, lemma, proposition, corollary, and example in the manuscript is proved as a `theorem` declaration in these modules; there are no unformalized or partially formalized numbered results.

B Index of Lean declarations

The following declarations are cited by formal-status lines. Names are relative to `BoundedArityDecoders`. A partial status retains the gap stated at its theorem.

`AffineCubeCompositionProofs.lean` `cauchySchwarzAffineCubeExtraction`, `control_D13TwoCubeAPFreeSharpness`, `control_D4SameIntervalCodedFactorization`, `lemma_AffineCubeCommonMessageGrowth`, `theorem2A_TwoStageRamseyFreeCutoff`.

`AffineCubeConsequences.lean` `control_D13_GeneralFieldAndProgressionBridge`, `control_D4_AllWidthsAndBinaryFields`, `denseSubset_AffineCubeCommonMessageBound`, `singleSubset_CauchySchwarzAffineCubeExtraction`, `theorem2A_GrowingClassesNonFactorization`.

`BoundedAritySetCapacityProofs.lean` `mem_shiftedFootprint_self_iff`, `selfReferentialAndCleanCount`.

`DualityAndSwapConsequences.lean` `antiDiagTensorEquiv_intertwines_rot`, `bonus1_UnifiedThreeTermExceedsPairingBound`, `bonus2_SublinearProfileAndTendstoHalf`, `bonus2_SublinearProfileExplicitThreshold`, `bonus2_WalshDichotomyStructuralProperties`, `boundedOSRPipelinePassLowerBound`, `isCyclicInterval_cyclicBoundaryCount_le_two`, `isPeriodicScaleDyadicMask_cyclicBoundaryCount`, `isRowOrColUniform_rankLe_one`, `maskFloor_GenericSubspaceRealization`, `rowDiagonal_SourceArityGaugeInvariance`, `shiftSetCovariance_tensor_finrank`, `skewOneTimePad_ShannonMutualInfoZero`, `uniformShannonMI_eq_zero_of_indep`, `walshBitSet_cyclicBoundaryCount`, `walshBitSet_joint_separates_points`, `walshDigitMaskRotSpan_finrank_le`.

`ExtensionAperiodicSixProofs.lean` `aperiodicSix_finrank_le_25`, `aperiodicSix_maxDim_eq_25`, `aperiodicSix_shift_inf_finrank_le_14`, `extension_Theorem2_AperiodicSixExact`, `extension_Theorem2_Preliminaries`.

`ExtensionFieldTransfer.lean` `coprimeToChar_iff_natCast_ne_zero`, `exists_isPrimitiveRoot_algebraicClosure`, `exists_isPrimitiveRoot_of_isAlgClosed`, `extendLinearMapPi_comp_map`, `finrank_le_of_pi_ringHom`, `linearIndependent_fin_pi_ringHom`.

`ExtensionLinearRun.lean` `laneRot_apply`.

`ExtensionLinearRunProofs.lean` `extension_Theorem1B_MultiClassPrime`, `extension_Theorem1B_TwoClass`, `linearClassUniform_multiClass_prime_finrank_le`, `linearClassUniform_multiClass_prime_maxDim_le`, `linearClassUniform_twoClass_finrank_le`, `multiClass_simplex_max_iff`.

`ExtensionLinearRunSharpness.lean` `alternatingSharpCode_finrank_and_shift_inf`, `extension_LinearModelAndCharBridges`, `extension_Theorem1A_AlternatingSharpness`.

`ExtensionLinearRunSingleShift.lean` `extension_Theorem1A_SingleShift`, `finrank_vanishCoeffs_le`, `linearClassUniform_singleShift_finrank_le`.

ExtensionTwoSidedProfileProofs.lean extension_Theorem3_ConcreteWinOverTP, extension_Theorem3_TwoSidedCoarseFine, swapCode_finrank_le_contiguousCoarseFine, swapCode_finrank_le_twoSidedCoarseFine.

MachineSweepConsequences.lean evalConeTree_cellSupport, evalConeTree_entryCellSupport_card_le, evalConeTree_traceConeTree_eq, padDummyWorkTape_transposesWithin, perColumnCutAbsorption_bracket_neg.

NativeSweepInterfaceProofs.lean entryBits_eq_clog, tmTraceCutConeDetermination.

OperatorDualityProofs.lean antiDiagonalTensorSeparation, control_RowShearAndRowDiagonalAlternation, control_SkewOneTimePadInformationTrap, hasOperatorSchmidtRankLe_comp, operatorSchmidtRankStoneShuffle, operatorSchmidtRankSubmultiplicative, operatorSchmidtRankSwap, pairwiseShiftCollisionCharacterization, stoneShufflePipelinePassLowerBound.

SetCapacityConsequences.lean asymptotic_SublinearClassesBrokenFractionRefutesRateOne, canonicalWordAlphabet_card_and_ge_two, corollary_OneClassArityOneHalf, corollary_OneClassArityTwoTwoThirds, exists_orderedRecoverableCells_bound, orderedRecoverable_injective_and_card_le, randomOrder_BoundedAritySetCapacity.

ShuffleShearBridge.lean rowShearTM_twoTape_linear, stoneShuffleTM_threeTape_linear, stoneUnshuffleTM_twoTape_linear, tmMatrix_gridLinear_bridges.

SumsetRankConsequences.lean control_D12_BandRowSpaceChannelEquiv, control_D12_UnconditionalExists, d12AddChar_injective_and_primitive, exists_primitive_twelfth_root_complex, finsetNatDiam_shift_min, sumsetAnnihilatingPolynomial_bandRowSpace, theorem2BExplicitConst_pos, theorem2BExplicitThreshold_eq_pow, theorem2B_ExplicitConstant, theorem2B_OneSecondStage_OmegaLog, unshiftedToShiftedSumset_intrinsicDiam.

SumsetRankDeficitProofs.lean control_D12SingleClassAbstractBand, cyclicChannelShift_aeval_ker_finrank_le, iteratedKovariSosTuranSumset, stackedBandPullbackInjective, sumsetAnnihilatingPolynomial, sumsetTwoHopRankBound, theorem2B_TwoStageLogPowerRankDeficit, unshiftedToShiftedSumset, vandermondeArbitrarySubsetInjective.

SwapCodeAnswersProofs.lean bonus1_ThreeTermBlockSwapCodeDim, bonus1_ThreeTermPaddedSevenAndFive, bonus2_MultiscaleFullProfileAttainsFullSwap, bonus2_MultiscaleIntervalBothSides, walshDigitMask_in_periodicDyadicSpan.

Other declarations named in the text CanonicalWordAlphabet, CausalConeTree, CoprimeToChar, GridState, HasCoarseFineIntervalDecomposition, HasExactOperatorSchmidtRank, HasOperatorSchmidtRankLe, HasOutputRowSourceArityLe, InAlignedDyadicIntervalRotSpan, InContiguousCoarseFineSpan, InCutCausalCone, InMultiscaleIntervalRotSpan, InMultiscalePeriodicDyadicRotSpan, InPairwiseShiftCovariance, IsAlignedDyadicInterval, IsAperiodicSixPartition, IsBoundedAritySetCode, IsColUniformRowOp, IsCutFreeCausalPath, IsCyclicInterval, IsFrozenTraceCutFibre, IsLastWorkVisit, IsLinearClassUniformCode, IsPeriodicScaleDyadicMask, IsRowDiagonalOp, IsRowUniformColOp, IsThreeByThreeSymmetricZeroTraceBlocks, ShiftLinkCovarianceSpace, SyntacticCellSupport, SyntacticColumnSupport, TMDepStep, ThreeAPFreeMod, altTwoColoring, alternatingRowDiagProduct,

alternatingSharpCode, alternatingSharpDecoder, antiDiagLinear, antiDiagTensorEquiv, boundaryControl_DeficitVanishesAtDeltaEqD, charBandEval, cleanEntries, composeGridOps, computesWithin_toTransposeTM, contiguousCoarseComplement, contiguousFineSet, coordShiftLinear, cutConeInputCells, cutTouchingOutputCells, cyclicBoundaryCount, cyclicChannelShift, cyclicRunCount, cyclicRunEndpointCount, encodeTMMatrixToGrid, evalConeTree, existsRecoverableSubsetBound, extendLinearMapPi, finsetNatDiam, fourierCoeffs, fromAntiDiagLinear, gridSwapLinear, growingClassesPositiveDeficit, halfIntervalPartition4, intervalMaskRotMatrix, laneOneMatrixEquiv, laneRot, leftComponentSubmodule, linearClassUniformMaxDim, matrixToSharedStateEquiv, modeLift, multiClassLeadingCoeff, oneHopRecoverableInjective, orbitClassCard, orbitRunCount, orderedCubeMap, orderedRecoverableCells, outputBitIdx, pMin_two_sided_theta_inv_arity, rowShearLinear, rowShearTMMatrix, rowShearTransposeTM, shiftGcd, shiftOrbit, shiftOrbitLen, shiftSetCovarianceSubmodule, shiftTransitionCount, shiftedFootprint, skewXorPad, stepRunBound, stoneShuffleGridLinear, stoneShuffleTMMatrix, stoneShuffleTransposeTM, stoneUnshuffleGridLinear, stoneUnshuffleTMMatrix, stoneUnshuffleTransposeTM, theorem1ASingleShiftBound, theorem1_BoundedAritySetCapacity, theorem2BExplicitConst, theorem2BExplicitThreshold, theorem3UnsymmetrizedBound, threeTermBlockA, threeTermBlockB, threeTermPaddedA, threeTermPaddedB, traceConeTree, treeCellSupport, trueConeSteps, uniformShannonMI, unrestrictedArity_ExactLogarithmicAsymptoticAllDimensions, unrestrictedArity_RateLowerBoundAndTendstoOne, vanishCoeffs, walshBitSet, walshDigitMaskRotMatrix.

C Building and verifying

The repository must be cloned together with its sibling directories (`lean-machine` and the earlier papers of the series) so that relative Lake path dependencies resolve. Both `lean-machine` and `BoundedArityDecoders` pin Lean 4 and Mathlib to version `v4.34.1`.

To verify the shared shuffle, unshuffle, and row-shear machines in `../lean-machine`, run from this paper's directory:

```
cd ../lean-machine
lake exe cache get
lake build
lake env lean Axioms.lean
```

Then return to this paper's directory, regenerate the declaration index and axiom audit, verify all proofs in `lean/`, and build the manuscript PDF:

```
cd ../Ramsey-Free-Bounds-for-Two-Stage-Shared-Decoder-Composition
python3 tools/lean_index.py
cd lean
lake exe cache get
lake build
lake env lean PaperAxioms.lean
cd ../paper
latexmk -pdf -interaction=nonstopmode -halt-on-error main.tex
```

Running `python3 tools/lean_index.py` regenerates `lean/BoundedArityDecoders.lean`, `lean/PaperAxioms.lean`, and Appendix B (`paper/sections/leanindex.tex`) directly from the `\formal` and `\lean` commands in `paper/sections/*.tex`. Every proved declaration audited in `Axioms.lean` and `PaperAxioms.lean` depends at most on Lean's three standard axioms `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`, with no `sorry`, `admit`, `native_decide`, `unsafe`, `implemented_by`, `extern`, or custom `axiom` declarations.

References

[1] Ziv Bar-Yossef, Yitzhak Birk, T. S. Jayram, and Tomer Kol. Index coding with side information. *IEEE Transactions on Information Theory*, 57(3):1479–1494, 2011. doi:10.1109/TIT.2011.2104992.

[2] F. A. Behrend. On sets of integers which contain no three terms in arithmetical progression. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*, 32(12):331–332, 1946. doi:10.1073/pnas.32.12.331.

[3] Hans Brende and Claude Fable 5.2 (Anthropic). Order, symmetry and the swap: A synthesis of matrix transposition on tapes. Manuscript and partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, November 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Order-Symmetry-and-the-Swap-A-Synthesis-of-Matrix-Transposition-on-Tapes.

[4] Hans Brende and Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic). Curved motion, depth reduction, and storage codes for matrix transposition on tapes. Manuscript and partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, October 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Curved-Motion-Depth-Reduction-and-Storage-Codes-for-Matrix-Transposition-on-Tapes.

[5] Hans Brende and Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic). Matrix transposition and the Tape Coding Conjecture. Manuscript and Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, October 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Matrix-Transposition-and-the-Tape-Coding-Conjecture.

[6] Hans Brende and Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic). Storage codes above half rate under paired-distance separation. Manuscript and partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, November 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Storage-Codes-above-Half-Rate-under-Paired-Distance-Separation.

[7] Hans Brende, Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic), and Gemini 4 Argon (Google DeepMind). Class-uniform codes in every characteristic but three, their blow-ups, and the price of advice. Memo to the seventeenth paper of the series, with partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, November 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Order-Symmetry-and-the-Swap-A-Synthesis-of-Matrix-Transposition-on-Tapes/memo-class-uniform-codes.

[8] Hans Brende and GPT-6 Astra (OpenAI). Capacity and composition of shared transposition decoders. Manuscript and partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, November 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/Capacity-and-Composition-of-Shared-Transposition-Decoders.

[9] Hans Brende and GPT-6 Astra (OpenAI). High-rate separated storage codes and tape transposition. Manuscript and partial Lean formalization, repository HansBrende/papers, November 2026. Pinned revision a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf. URL: https://github.com/HansBrende/papers/tree/a445cd8254afe6b1123cd5de325482ff4d2d3edf/High-Rate-Separated-Storage-Codes-and-Tape-Transposition.

[10] A. W. Hales and R. I. Jewett. Regularity and positional games. *Transactions of the American Mathematical Society*, 106(2):222–229, 1963. URL: https://www.jstor.org/stable/1993764, doi:10.1090/S0002-9947-1963-0143712-1.

[11] David Harvey and Joris van der Hoeven. Integer multiplication is at least as hard as matrix transposition. arXiv:2503.22848; also in Proc. FOCS 2025, pp. 1366–1381 (numbering as in arXiv), 2025. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.22848.

[12] T. Kővári, V. T. Sós, and P. Turán. On a problem of K. Zarankiewicz. *Colloquium Mathematicum*, 3(1):50–57, 1954. doi:10.4064/cm-3-1-50-57.

[13] Harold S. Stone. Parallel processing with the perfect shuffle. *IEEE Transactions on Computers*, C-20(2):153–161, 1971. doi:10.1109/T-C.1971.223205.

[14] The mathlib Community. Mathlib, 2026. Version 4.34.1; pinned revision d13f23b723b8a846827a245b89c10fc7d3f11612. URL: https://github.com/leanprover-community/mathlib4/tree/d13f23b723b8a846827a245b89c10fc7d3f11612.